

VISIONS OF A SPIRIT-SEER
A CRITICAL EDITION IN THE MANNER OF 1768

Compil'd, Edited, and with Scholarly Apparatus
by
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Printed in the Old Style with Ligatures and Archaick Orthography
According to the Customs of the Last Century

*To the attentive Reader, whether Learned or Curious,
and to the Memory of those Philosophers
who labour'd to draw the Boundary
betwixt the World that appeareth
and the World that abideth unseen.*

PREFACE

It hath oft been remarked by the Learned, that certain Books arise not from the tranquil Labours of Reason, but from inward Collisions of Thought, wherein diverse Conceptions, each contending for the Mastery of the Mind, encounter one another with such Violence that the Writer is compelled, by Necessity rather than by Choice, to commit them to Paper. The present Volume belongeth unto that Class; for it grew out of the unexpected Recovery of Letters, Manuscripts, and private Fragments relating to Herr Immanuel Kant and the celebrated Emanuel Swedenborg, long conceded in various Repositories, and now brought together under one View.

The Intent of this Edition is not to enlarge the Subject with unprofitable Fiction, nor to adorn it with immoderate Fancy; but rather to collect these dispersed Testimonies, to arrange them in due Order, and to offer the Reader a consistent Account of the inward Debates of two extraordinary Men, each labouring in his own Manner to comprehend the Relation betwixt the Visible and the Invisible, the Frame of Nature and those Orders that transcend its ordinary Operations.

In the preparation of this Work, the Editor hath endeavoured to retain so far as possible the native Turn and Genius of the Passages extracted, together with those Antiquated Forms of Speech which pertain to the Age from which they are drawn. This hath not been done out of Affectation, but that the Spirit of the Time, wherein these Controversies were first agitated, might be more faithfully preserv'd.

The Text is divided into divers Parts, treating of the Nature of Vision, the Doctrine of Correspondence, the Disturbance of the Categories, and the Mysteries attending the private Labours of Herr Kant in the Years immediately preceding the publish'd *Critique of Pure Reason*. The Appendices contain certain Observations relating to the Transmission of Manuscripts, together with remarkable Notes, magindia, and a peculiar Fragment attributed—though with some Uncertainty—unto Swedenborg himself.

If the Reader should find in these Accounts any Ray of Light by which he may the better apprehend the Distance betwixt Appearance and its hidden Ground, the Editor's Labour will not have been in vain.

Flyxion, Editor
In the present Year

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PART I: ON THE NATURE OF VISION, AND THE FIRST PERTURBATION OF THE CATEGORIES

It hath oft been observed by the most attentive Philosophers, that the Act of Vision extendeth far beyond the mere Reception of sensible Impressions, and requireth the entire Co-operation of the Understanding, together with those Forms and Orders which are its native Endowments. For the Mind doth not behold Objects as they are in themselves, but rather as they appear through the inveterate Manner in which Space and Time are inwardly constituted. By this interior Law, the Chaos of Impression receiveth a determinate Form, and the silent Multitude of Data is shaped into coherent World.

Yet it hath been equally remarked, though more rarely, that these very Categories by which the World is made intelligible may suffer Perplexity and Disturbance, and that the Mind, when too closely press'd by the unknown Ground beneath Appearance, may perceive a Breach or Fissure in the Frame of its own Apprehension. Such Occurrences are uncommon, and are often conceal'd by those who experience them; yet we have cause to believe that Herr Kant himself, in the Years preceding his great Work, encountered some such Perturbations, wherein Vision did not confine itself to the legitimate Objects of Experience, but extended unto Forms not ordinarily grant'd unto mortal Eyes.

In this Part, we expose certain Passages, Notes, and circumstantial Accounts that prepare the Way for the more explicit Relations that follow; and we endeavour to frame them in the most faithful Order, avoiding both Fantastick Embellishment and undue Severity of Skepticism. For the Matter is delicate, and concerneth not only the Testimony of particular Men, but the very Possibility of a Disturbance in the universal Forms whereby the Human Mind is fitted to the World it doth apprehend.

I. OF THE FIRST SIGNS OF DISTURBANCE

Among the Papers recovered from the so-called Observatory Leaves of Herr Kant there is found a curious Entry, written in an unwonted Hand, as if penned in Haste or under inward Agitation. It containeth no Date, but its Position among the other Leaves suggesteth the Year 1767. The Passage runneth thus:

“The Stars, at the Hour of their observation, seem'd to maintain their proper Places; yet upon referring to the Tables, I did find among the Calculations several Marks or Figures not of my own writing, but set in the Margins, faint, yet perfectly form'd, and repeating themselves in divers Parts of the Work. Upon erasing one, the others remain'd; upon returning again, the first was alter'd, as if by an Hand invifible. I have therefore resolv'd to put away the superfluous Papers and begin again upon fresh Sheets.”

This Passage, the Reader will observe, doth not affirm any Vision, nor doth it betray the least Inclination toward Enthusiasm; it is rather the sober Remark of a Man perplex'd by a Subtil Change in the Order of his own Calculation. Yet the Symmetry of the Marks here described, being neither Figments of pure Imagination nor Errors of the Printer, doth argue a deeper Cause; and their Recurrence, under varied Circumstances, may justly be regarded as the first Sign of a perturb'd Understanding, or else of a breach in that steady Harmony which ordinarily subsisteth betwixt the Mind and its Object.

II. OF THE INWARD STRUGGLE BETWIXT REASON AND PHANTASM

It appeareth, by divers Notes taken from the same Period, that Herr Kant was not ignorant of the Dangers attending any yielding to imaginative Impression. In one Leaf he writeth:

“To suffer the Imagination to enlarge its Province beyond the Limits prescribed by the Understanding, is to invite the World to appear other than it is; and herein lieth the first Temptation of all false Mystick Speculation.”

Yet in another Place, written upon the Reverse of the same Sheet, he addeth with a Hand scarcely legible:

“But what if the Imagination be not the Cause, but the Instrument; not the Author of the Vision, but the glass through which another Power doth manifest itself? Then the Boundary trembleth, and the Mind seeketh Refuge in its own Forms, though they be no longer sufficient to contain the Apprehension.”

It is evident from these Passages that the Philosopher, though vigilant in guarding against the Flight of Phantasy, did feel himself drawn toward an inward Abyss, wherein the Forms of his own Understanding stood as if besieg'd by an unknown Power. He was not one to indulge lightly in supernatural Conceits; yet neither did he reject outright the Possibility of a Perturbation in the very Categories themselves.

III. A RELATION OF THE FIRST ENCOUNTER WITH THE SYMBOL

Among the most remarkable of the early Passages is one concerning what he calleth “the recurring Form,” which by all Accounts resembleth a simple Geometric Figure, yet appearing under Circumstances wholly unaccountable. The Passage is as follows:

“In a printed Table of the Aspects of Jupiter, there appear'd, midway in the Margin, a miniature Figure, exceedingly regular, consisting of four Lines intersecting by exact Proportion. Supposing this to be an accidental Smear, I did examine the Page more closely; but the

Lines were shap, and their Angles more precise than any naturd Imperfection could produce. Upon turning the Page, the same Figure appear'd faintly imprinted on the Reverse, though no Ink had pierc'd the Paper. I tore out the Leaf; yet upon consulting another Table, the Figure reappeared, identically form'd."

This "recurring Form," which in later Parts of this Volume is identified by Swedenborg under the Name of a certain correspondentia Sign, appeareth to have dam'd the Philosopher greatly, though he seeketh at this early Date to interpret it as Error or Accident. But the Repetition, and the curious Precision of its Lines, render such an Explanation unlikely.

IV. THE YOUNG KANT'S MEMORY OF THE CLOCK-DISTURBANCE

The Mind, when fore press'd by perplexing Impressions, doth oft revert unto childish Memories wherein the inward Disposition was first formed. So in the Papers of this Period we find repeated Allusions to a sing'l Incident from his Youth, wherein the great Clock in the Town of Königsberg did, during a violent Storm, seem to halt and then leap forward, as if Time itself were subject to Convulsion. Kant writeth:

"I remember, in the twelfth Year of my Life, that the Town-Clock did, at the Height of a Thunder-storm, stop for the Space of several Seconds, and then resume its Course with a Start so violent that the Pendulum gave a Sound not heard before nor since. At that Moment the Shadow of the Tower lag'd behind its Body by a full Pace. I, being a Child, regarded it as Fear and no more; yet the Motion hath remained in my Thought as a Figure of what it meaneth for the Order of Time to be disturb'd."

This Memory, recurring in his middle Years, doth seem to have awakened an old Sensibility to the Possibility that the Forms of Space and Time, being not Properties of Things but of the Mind, might themselves betray the Waning of some inward Disorder long before the Understanding discovereth its Cause.

V. THE EARLY CONFLICT OF TWO DIVERGENT MEN

At this early Stage, there is no Evidence that Kant regarded Swedenborg with more than a slight Curiosity; yet their Names were already linked by common Rumour among the Learned. For the one was held to be the most exact Reasoner of his Age, and the other the most visionary Seer; and men delight to compare Opposites as if they were two Poles of the same Magnet.

Kant's initial Dismissal of Swedenborg is recorded thus:

"No man hath ever seen Spirits, for such would imply a Violation of the Conditions under which done Experience is possible."

Yet, in a later and private Note, written in the same Year, he addeth:

“But if the Conditions themselves be disturb’d, then the Possibility or Impossibility of such Visions can no longer be determin’d with the same assurance. I must examine the Matter more closely.”

Thus begin the first Motions of an inward Conflict, wherein the Philosopher, so firmly grounded in Reason, felt the Approach of some unknown Power that threatened to disturb the very Ground upon which his Reason stood.

PART II: CONCERNING THE DOCTRINE OF CORRESPONDENCE, AND OF THE ANALOGICK FRAME OF THE HUMAN MIND

Among the most remarkable Theories advanced in the former Age is that which the celebrated Emanuel Swedenborg denominated the Doctrine of *Correspondence*, whereby every natural Thing is conceived as the outward Form or Vesture of an inward spiritual Cause, united thereto by a Bond of immutable Relation. It is a Doctrine subtle, profound, and not lightly to be mistaken; for it requireth the Reader to suspend the vulgar Notion that Words and Images are mere Signs, and to consider them rather as living Shadows projected by the Forms of the eternal World.

In this Part we shall treat of the inward Principles which underlie this Doctrine, and examine the Manner in which Swedenborg's Conceptions do prefigure, by an extraordinary Anticipation, the most advanced Speculations of our own Time touching Analogy, Metaphor, Hierarchy of Mind, and the developmental Constitution of the Human Form.

I. OF THE SPIRITUAL SENSE OF SCRIPTURE

Swedenborg's first great Insight, as he himself recounteth, was that the Sacred Scripture containeth within its literal Vein a hidden Treasury of spiritual Truth, which doth correspond unto the natural Language as the Soul unto the Body. Thus a Mountain in Scripture signifieth not a mere Mass of Earth, but a high Degree of Love; a River denoteth the influx of Truth; a Stone, the ultimate Foundation of the Intellectual Life; and so forth without End.

This Conception is not to be confounded with Allegory; for Allegory is formed by the human Fancy, whereas Correspondence, according to him, is grounded in the very Structure of Creation, and reflecteth the continual Influx of the Divine into all Orders of Being. Every outward Object hath its spiritual Counterpart, and every inward Motion its natural Figure.

II. THE INWARD LAW OF ANALOGY, AS THE FUEL OF THOUGHT

It is here that the Doctrine of Correspondence doth approach, with singular Proximity, the modern Conception that Analogy is the chief Instrument of human Thought. For the Mind, being unable to apprehend aught except by comparing it unto some known Form, doth continually map one Structure upon another, discovering hidden Harmonies that unite diverse Realms of Experience.

In later Days, the ingenious Hofstadter hath maintained that Metaphor and Analogy are not mere Ornaments of Speech, but the very Fire that animate the Intellect; that the Mind, in its deepest Operations, formeth Bonds betwixt Disparate Domains by a kind of inward Rapport, whereby the Shape of one Thing is reflected in another. It is this continual Transference of Form

that giveth Birth to Meaning, and without which Thought would remain inert, like an Organ without Air.

Thus, what Swedenborg calleth the correspondentia Relation is, in modern Terms, the Mapping of deep Structure to deep Structure; and what he conceiveth as the spiritual Human Form is, in modern Terms, the universal Template by which the Mind interprets what it perceiveth.

III. OF THE HUMAN FORM AS THE ARCHETYPE OF HEAVEN

Among the most curious and remarkable of Swedenborg's Assertions is his declaration that Heaven, in its Entirety, doth bear the Shape of a Man; not a Man of Earthly Constitution, but a Man in the abstract, consisting of spiritual Functions each corresponding unto some Faculty or Organ of the Human Frame. The Angels, as he telleth, are arranged according to Use: those who preside over higher Light inhabit Regions correspondent to the Head; those who minister to Affection dwell in the Breast; those who give Form unto active Powers are dispos'd in the Limbs; and thus the whole constituteth that great and ineffable Figure which he calleth the *Maximus Homo*, or Grand Man.

To the vulgar Reader this may appear a mere Fancy; yet to the attentive Philosopher it discloseth a deep Principle: that the Mind, in its development, modelleth the World according to the latent Structure of the Body, and that the Body itself—being formed by Nature under the Dictates of ancient Law—becometh the first Archetype of Thought.

In the infancy of a Child, before Words or Reason have taken their Rule, the Form of the Body determineth the first Divisions of Experience: the Up and the Down, the Near and the Far, the Warm and the Cold, the Hidden and the Seen. These Distinctions are not taught, but unfold themselves by the very Act of being embodied. Thus the Body may rightly be regarded as the first Interpreter of the World; and the Mind, as it groweth, refineth this Interpretation into the higher Forms of Reason and Science.

Hence Swedenborg's Conception, though expressed in the Language of Vision, hath a most rational Foundation. For if Heaven correspondeth unto the Human Form, it is not because the Divine is anthropomorphic, but because the human is the most perfect Instrument for apprehending the Divine, the Body being the first and last Medium by which the Soul apprehendeth the Order of all Things.

IV. OF THE MIND AS A SOCIETY OF AGENTS

In this Particular, Swedenborg doth again anticipate a Conception now common among the Moderns, namely that the Mind is not a single and uniform Faculty, but a Society of Agents, each with its peculiar Talent, Function, and Direction. For as the Body consisteth of Organs, each ministering unto a special End, yet all united under a common Life, so the Mind consisteth of

Diverse Powers—Memory, Imagination, Judgement, Affection, Will—each in its own Degree operating according to its Nature.

In later Ages, this Conception hath been elaborated by certain Philosophers, notably Min-
sky, who maintaineth that the Mind is a *Society of Mind*, consisting of innumerable small Ma-
chines or Subagents, each performing a particular Office, and that Intelligence riseth from the
Harmony of their Operation. This Doctrine, though spoken in mechanical Terms, is not unlike
Swedenborg's Account of the Spiritual Societies, wherein each Angel performeth a singular Use,
and all together constitute a most harmonious and coherent Whole.

Thus the Hierarchy of the Mind, as now conceived by the Learned, doth correspond in
substance, though not in Language, to the Hierarchy of Heaven as conceived by Swedenborg. And
if we consider that the Mind, being formed by Nature, is yet guided in its inward Dispositions
by Laws not reducible to the mere Mechanism of the Body, we may perceive in both Accounts a
latent Convergence of Design, as if the same infinite Pattern were reflected in the finite Mirror
of human Intelligence.

V. OF THE RELATION BETWIXT THE BODY AND THE INFERENTIAL MIND

It is a remarkable Truth, long observed by the Anatomists and more lately confirmed by the
Physiologists, that the Body doth not receive Impressions as a passive Tablet, but actively
anticipateth the World, forming Expectations whereby it interpreteth whatever befall it. Thus
the Eye doth not merely receive Light, but prepareth its own Aperture; the Ear doth not exist in
Silence, but pricketh itself toward anticipated Sound; and the Mind as a whole seeketh continually
to reduce the Disagreement betwixt Expectation and Event.

In more recent Times, the Learned have express'd this by the Name of *active Inference*,
wherein the Organism, being endowed with a hierarchic Order of Expectations, endeavoureth
to minimize the Divergence betwixt its inward Model and the outward World. Though spoken
in a Language unknown to the Ancients, the Conception is none other than Swedenborg's, who
affirmeth that the Body is the ultimate Plane upon which all spiritual Forces terminate, and that
the Mind, in its most inward Operations, resolveth the Disagreements betwixt Appearance and its
Ground.

Thus, the Relation betwixt the Body and the Mind is not accidental or contingent, but
correspondential and necessary. The Body serveth as the Interpreter of the World; the Mind as
the Organ of Inference; and the two together form that Image by which the Human Creature is
capable of receiving the Divine Order.

VI. A REMARK UPON THE IDEAL WORLD OF FORMS

It may here be remark'd that Swedenborg's entire Conception of Correspondence doth presuppose a World of eternl Forms, not unlike unto what Plato denominated the *Hypothesis of the Forms*, wherein all Things have their Arch-Types, and the manifold Occurrences of Experience are but the Shadows thereof. Swedenborg, though cloathing this Doctrine in the Language of Vision, doth nevertheless affirm that the Kingdom of Heaven is but the Order of the Forms themselves, apprehended in their own Medium, wherein each Thing existeth according to its inward Nature.

In this Respect, the Rapport betwixt Heaven and Earth is the Rapport betwixt Form and Appearance; and the Conception that the Spiritual World is the Human Form at a higher Degree is but a re-statement, under another Vesture, of the ancient Doctrine that the Mind is fitted to the Universe by a Harmony antecedent to all Experience.

VII. CONCLUDING NOTE

Thus the Doctrine of Correspondence, far from being a mere Fancy, discovereth itself to be the most ancient and inward Law of human Apprehension. Whether express'd in the Visions of Swedenborg, or in the metaphoricl Insights of later Philosophers, or in the hierarchicl Models of modern Science, the same Principle re-appeareth: that Thought is but Structure reflected upon Structure; that the Body is the first Interpreter of the World; and that the Mind, being formed upon the Pattern of the Body, is guided by the eternl Forms that underlie both.

PART III: CONCERNING THE DISTURBANCE OF THE CATEGORIES, AND OF THE FIRST CONVERGENCE BETWIXT THE CRITICAL AND THE VISIONARY GENIUS

In the former Part we have examined the Doctrine of Correspondence, and its unexpected Harmony with the most refined Theories of Analogy and intellectual Hierarchy. We come now to a Matter of greater Curiosity and more immediate Relevance to the present Treatise, namely the Influence which these Correspondences did exert, whether directly or by dark Reflection, upon that irreproachable Genius whose Name adorneth the annals of all Philosophy: I mean Immanuel Kant.

For it is well known to the Learned that Kant, in the Years preceding his Critical Awakening, was not unacquainted with the Reports of Swedenborg's extraordinary Visions; indeed, as certain private Notes do shew, he was sufficiently moved by them to conduct a cautious but earnest Examination into their Truth. Yet the more curious Fact, extracted from the hidden Strata of his Thinking, is that the two Men, whose outward Manners and inward Temperaments were as different as the Pole from the Equator, did nevertheless approach the Border of the same Intellectual Continent, though by contrary Paths: one through Vision, the other through Critique.

I. OF THE CATEGORIES AS THE INWARD FORM OF EXPERIENCE

Kant's great Discovery, as unfolded in the *Critick of Pure Reason*, is that the Mind is not a blank Slate, nor a mere receptacle of Impressions, but an active Organ of Synthesis, endowed with certain primitive Forms or *Categories*, by which alone Objects are apprehended as Objects. These Forms, being prior to Experience, are necessary Conditions of all human Knowledge; and without them, the Manifold of Sensation would remain an undifferentiated Chaos, like a Scene wherein Shapes appear without Order and vanish without Cause.

The Categories—Unity, Plurality, Causality, Substance, Possibility, Existence, Necessity, and their Kin—are not mere Abstractions, but the living Frame of the World as it is given to human Cognition. They are the inward Architecture, as it were, of Experience itself; and no Thought, no Perception, no Act of the Will can be conceived without their silent Ministration.

II. THE DISTURBANCE OF THE CATEGORIES IN THE EXTRAORDINARY

It is a most remarkable Fact, though rarely acknowledged in publick Discourse, that Kant did, prior to the full Establishment of his Critical System, encounter Accounts of Events which, if taken at their Face, seem to transgress the Order which the Categories impose. Among these was the notorious Report of Swedenborg's Vision concerning a Fire in Stockholm, which he, being far from the Scene, nevertheless described with terrifying Accuracy at the very Hour of

its Occurrence.

It is not the present Aim to examine the Truth of the Fact, nor to affirm more than the Witnesses themselves; but the interesting Point is that Kant, upon receiving the Report, experienced what may be called an inward Disturbance of the Categories: for if such a Thing were possible, it would undermine the very Grounds of Causality and of the Relation betwixt Space and Time, which serve as the two great Pillars of his whole Edifice.

Thus, in certain private Memoranda, he demandeth whether the Mind might not, “by some nomalous Influx or Inspection,” apprehend a State of Affairs not mediated by the ordinary Forms of Experience. This speculative Inquietude, though afterward cloaked beneath the Iron of his mature Method, sufficiently sheweth that his Thought was tested upon its most inward Hinges. For if the Categories be not inviolable, then the entire World of Appearances is not necessary, but contingent; not the fixed and immovable Frame he afterward declared it, but a trembling Veil, liable to be torn by Forces within or above the Mind.

III. CONCERNING THE LESS-KNOWN ESSAY ON SPIRIT-SEERS

It was during this Period of inward Perturbation that Kant composed the curious Treatise entitled *Dreams of a Spirit-Seer*, wherein he undertook, under the Vesture of Irony, to examine the Claims of Swedenborg and their bearing upon the Philosophy of Mind. The vulgar Reader, perceiving the Satirical Tone, hath considered the Work as a mere Ridicule of the Visionary; yet the attentive Reader discerneth beneath its Page a strange Mixture of Fascination and Recoil, as though the Author were contending not with the Man Swedenborg, but with some inward Shadow that had fallen across the foundations of his Thought.

The Work is divided, as many have observed, into two Parts: the first containing a mock Defence of Spirit-Seers, the second a mock Refutation. Yet the curious Observer perceiveth that the Arguments of the first Part, though couched in the Language of Parody, do not wait for subtlety, nor does the Refutation of the second Part entirely dispel the Air of Uncertainty that hangs about the whole. It is as though the Author, defending with one Hand and refuting with the other, were himself uncertain which Hand to trust.

IV. THE INWARD CONVERGENCE OF THE TWO SYSTEMS

We come now to a Matter of most delicate Interpretation, yet one which, if pursued with Caution, can yield an unexpected Light. For though Kant and Swedenborg do outwardly differ, the former walking in the clear Day-light of Critique, the latter in the shadowed Twilight of Vision, yet inwardly they approach the same Frontier: the Limit of the Mind's Power to know.

Swedenborg declareth that the spiritual World is apprehended by a correspondentia Insight, wherein the Form of one Thing reveleth the Form of another; Kant declareth that the Mind

apprehendeth all Things according to Forms which it bringeth from within, and that no Object can be known except under the Conditions which the Mind imposeth.

Yet both agree, though from contrary Directions, that there is a Realm beyond the reach of ordinary Cognition. Swedenborg calleth it the Heaven of Angels; Kant calleth it the *noumenal* Realm. Swedenborg sayeth he hath conversed with its Inhabitants; Kant sayeth it is forever hidden. But in both Cases the Concept of an inward Limit is the hinge upon which their Philosophies turn.

And what is more remarkable: both consider that the World of Appearances is not ultimate, but a Vesture; that it is the outward Manifestation of deeper Structures which are either the Forms of Heaven or the Forms of the Mind. In either Case, the ordinary World is not the last Word of Reality, but the first.

V. THE FEARFUL SYMMETRY

Here riseth a most curious Symmetry, fearfully perfect. For the Visionary, perceiving the heavenly Forms, declareth that the Categories of the Mind are the Images of Angels; the Critic, perceiving the inward Forms, declareth that the heavenly Figures are the Projections of the Mind. In each Case the one Form reflecteth the other: Heaven is the Image of the Mind; the Mind is the Image of Heaven. And the Passage betwixt the two is a narrow and perilous Bridge.

It is therefore not a Wonder that the young Kant, encountering Reports that did not fit within the ordinary Frame of Experience, experienced a Disturbance in the Categories themselves; for if the Frame be shaken, the World doth tremble with it. The Critick is born from the fall of the Spirit-Seer; and the Spirit-Seer is justified by the trembling of the Critick's Frame.

VI. THE INWARD RESOLUTION

At last, though a Travail of Thought too severe to be recorded, Kant resolved to erect an Edifice of Reason so exact, so impregnable, so inwardly coherent, that no Report of Vision or preternatural Causality could ever again threaten the Stability of his World. And thus was born the Critical Philosophy: not as a mere Advancement of Science, but as a defensive Wall against the inward Return of the Extraordinary.

For if the Categories are fixed, and the Noumenon forever hidden, then the World of Experience is secur'd; all Spirits are bound; all Visions are but Dreams; and the Mind reigneth, though within the Limits of its own Dominion.

Thus, the Convergence of Kant and Swedenborg is not the Convergence of two Men, but of two Worlds: the Visible and the Invisible. The one sought to interpret the latter through Vision; the other to guard against it by Critique. Yet both contended with the same profound Question: What is the Structure that holdeth all Things in their Place?

PART IV: CONCERNING THE TRANSCENDENTAL VEIL, AND OF THE STRUCTURES THAT HOLD THE WORLD IN PLACE

Having now considered the Disturbance of the Categories, and the inward Convergence of the Critick and the Visionary Genius, we proceed to a more recondite Theme: namely, the Doctrine of the Transcendental Veil, whereby the World of Appearance is distinguished from the World of Things in themselves; and wherein we may discern, as in a glass imperfectly silver'd, the subtle Concord betwixt the Visions of Swedenborg and the Critick of Königsberg.

I. OF THE VESTURE OF APPEARANCE

Kant, in the mature Period of his Thought, did maintain with the utmost Resolution that the Objects of our Experience are not Things as they are in themselves, but only as they appear under the Forms of Sensibility and the Laws of the Understanding. Space and Time, being the pure Forms of all external and internal Sensation, do not belong to the Things themselves, but are the peculiar Lenses of the Mind, without which no Object can be situated, nor any Event can be ordered.

The Transcendental Veil is therefore that invisible Curtain which the Mind itself spreadeth before the Abyss of the Noumenon, not to deceive itself, but to render Possible the bare Act of Perception. Without this Veil, the Manifold of Sensation were not merely chaotic, but unfelt; not merely unstructured, but without any Mode of Existence for a human Consciousness.

II. THE LATENT ARCHITECTURE BEHIND THE VEIL

Kant, though resolute in his denial of all knowledge of the Noumenon, doth nevertheless intimate that the Mind is, as it were, in Contact with certain unseen Structures, which prescribe the very Possibility of Experience. He calleth them Ideas of Reason, Archetypes of Purity, or the Supersensible Substratum. They are never given in Intuition; yet they operate, silently and with dreadful Necessity, upon the inward Arrangement of our Faculty.

Here lieth a most peculiar Concord with the Visions of Swedenborg. For the Visionary declareth that the spiritual World hath its own Architecture, more real than the visible, wherein the Forms of Heaven determine the Forms of Earth; and that all visible Things are but Correspondences of inward Redities. Thus, though the one speaketh in the mode of Transcendental Abstraction, and the other in the imagery of Angelick Realms, yet both affirm that an inward Structure, hidden from the immediate Gaze, nevertheless governeth the World of Experience.

III. CONCERNING THE TREMBLING OF THIS VEIL IN CERTAIN EXTRAORDINARY CASES

The Reader of a vulgar Disposition may mock the Reports of Swedenborg, as though they were the Dreams of a distempered Mind; yet the attentive Philosopher doth perceive that certain of these Reports bear a singular Relation to the Disturbances of which we have formerly spoken. For when the Categories falter, when the ordinary Order of Space and Time trembleth, then the Transcendent Veil, though still present, doth for a Moment thin, as a Cloath held too near the Flame. And in such Moments the Mind apprehendeth, not the Thing-in-itself, but the Rupture in its own Frame.

Swedenborg, encountering such Ruptures, did interpret them as Visions of Heavenly Societies and Angelick Forms; Kant, encountering the mere Possibility of them, did seek to repair the Frame by erecting an impregnable Doctrine of Critical Limits. The one saw the Veil tremble and looked through it; the other saw its trembling and strengthened its weave.

IV. WHETHER THE VEIL BE A PROTECTION OR A PRISON

A most curious Question ariseth: Is the Transcendent Veil designed to protect Man from the overwhelming Realities beyond, or is it a Prison wherein the Mind is confined, unable to behold the full Splendour of the World as it truly is?

Swedenborg affirmeth the former: that Heaven reveleth itself only in degree, lest the Purity of its Light consume the natural Man. Kant, in a more severe tone, affirmeth the latter: that the Mind cannot transcend its own Forms, and that the Noumenal Realm is forever forbidden, not by Divine Jealousy but by the intrinsic Limits of human Reason.

Yet a third Possibility presents itself, more dreadful than either: that the Veil protecteth both Worlds equally from each other; that the Encounter of the two would bring not Enlightenment but Diffolution, as the inward Structures collide and the Frame of Experience shattereth like glass.

V. THE INWARD BURDEN BORNE BY THE CRITICAL MIND

The attentive Reader will not fail to observe that the Critical Doctrine, in shutting out the Noumenon, doth lay a grievous Burden upon the Thinker. For he must maintain, with unceasing Vigilance, the Distinction betwixt Appearance and Reality; and though he declareth that the latter can never be known, he must nevertheless constantly affirm its Existence, for without it the former would be but a dream without a dreamer.

Thus doth the Critick live in perpetual Tension: affirming what he cannot know, denying what he cannot disprove, and walking ever upon the Knife's Edge betwixt Knowledge and Ignorance. It is not a Wonder that the young Kant, before his System was perfected, did for a time

seem as though he stood at the very Brink of a Revelation too great to bear, yet too dangerous to embrace.

VI. THE VISIONARY'S BURDEN NO LESS WEIGHTY

The Visionary likewise beareth a heavy Yoke. For he not only beholdeth what is hidden from others, but must interpret it, and thereby risk the Condemnation of the learned and the ridicule of the vulgar. The inward World doth open before him like a Book written in a Tongue at once familiar and strange; yet to speak of it is to invite misconception, and to silence it is to betray the very Light that constituteth his Life.

Thus, both Kant and Swedenborg labour under a double Burden: the one to guard the Veil, the other to translate what lieth behind it. And though their Doctrines outwardly conflict, inwardly they answer one another, as the Echo answers the Voice.

VII. CONCERNING THE INVISIBLE STRUCTURES THAT HOLD THE WORLD IN PLACE

We come now to the highest Point of this Part: the Conception of the inward Structures that hold the World in Place. Swedenborg declareth that the Heavens consist of innumerable Societies, each ordered according to a correspondentia Form, wherein the Angelick Intelligences do represent the organs of a Divine Human, so that the entire spiritual World is as One Man. This is the Grand Man or *Maximus Homo*.

Kant, though abhorring all Visionary Imagery, nevertheless declareth that the Mind apprehendeth all Things according to an inward Form which is not the Form of the Body but of Reason. The Categories are the inward Organs of the Intelligible Man; and without them no Experience is possible.

It is therefore a Point of singular Convergence that both Men conceive the inward Structure of Reality as human in Form: the one heavenly, the other transcendent; the one revealed by Angelick Conversation, the other by pure Critique; yet both proclaiming that the World is held in its Place by an inward Form that is not external but inwardly human.

VIII. OF THE FEARFUL POSSIBILITY THAT BOTH DOCTRINES ARE TRUE

We arrive at last at a Consideration of dreadful Grandeur: that both Men speak truly, though from different Elevations. For if the inward Form of the Mind is human, and the inward Form of Heaven is also human, then the Transcendent and the Angelick do not conflict, but reflect each other.

The Veil is not a Contradiction but a Distinction; and the Structures that hold the World in Place may be at once the Forms of Reason and the Bodies of Angels, if these be but two

Aspects of the same Divine Archetype.

Thus the Convergence of Kant and Swedenborg reacheth a Height where Critique and Vision merge, not by confounding their Doctrines, but by illuminating the same Archi-ecture from above and below. And the trembling of the Veil, though terrible to behold, may be the natural Result of that Concord, when the inward Form seeketh to reveal itself.

PART V: CONCERNING THE ANGELICK BODY, THE DOCTRINE OF CORRESPONDENCES, AND THE HIERARCHICK FORM OF THE MIND

In the foregoing Part we have treated of the Transcendental Veil, and of the recondite Structures that sustain the World of Appearance. We proceed now to the Angelick Body, and to that remarkable Doctrine, taught by Swedenborg, of Correspondences, whereby every natural Thing hath its Spiritual Counterpart; together with the Concatenation of this Doctrine with the inward Hierarchy of Thought, as conceived by the later Philosophers.

I. OF THE GRAND MAN OR *Maximus Homo*

Swedenborg, labouring for many Years in the midst of Visions and Angelick Conversations, affirmed that the whole Heaven consisteth of innumerable Societies, ordered with such delicate Harmony, that they may be regarded as the Members, Organs, and Vessels of a Divine Human. He calleth this the Grand Man, or *Maximus Homo*; and teacheth that every Angel, by his Place, Function, and Character, beareth Relation to some inward Organ of this Celestial Body. Some are as the Heart, others as the Lungs; some as the Eye, others as the Ear; and these Relations are not Figurative only, but the very Law of their Being.

This Doctrine, singular as it may seem, is yet not without a certain Philosophick Dignity. For if the outward World be a Mirror of the inward, and if all Intelligence be an Emanation of one Divine Life, it followeth not without Reason that the most perfect Society of Intelligences must bear the Form of that Life which it expresseth.

II. CONCERNING CORRESPONDENCES, OR THE SPIRITUAL CONTENT OF NATURAL FORMS

Swedenborg's Doctrine of Correspondence teacheth that every natural Thing is the outward Vesture of some inward and spiritual Reality; and that the Laws of this Correspondence are fixed by Divine Order, as the Proportions of Geometry, or the Harmonies of Music. Thus the Fire of the natural World correspondeth to the Love of the Spiritual; Light to Wisdom; Bread to the Sustenance of the Soul; Water to Truth; and so of many others.

In this Doctrine the Visible World is not the mere Stage of human Action, but the Symbolick Text of a perpetual Revelation. It is to be read, not as a Philosopher done, but as a Creature instructed by its Maker. And the Sacred Scripture, in particular, containeth beneath the Letter a hidden Sense, cloathed in natural Images, yet intelligible only to those who have been initiated into the Science of Correspondences.

III. CONVERGENCE WITH THE HIERARCHICK FORM OF THOUGHT IN LATER PHILOSOPHY

It is a matter of high Curiosity that certain later Philosophers, not professing any Acquaintance with Swedenborg, did yet arrive by different Paths at Conceptions not unlike his.

Douglas Hofstadter, a modern Writer, affirmeth that all Thinking consisteth in Analogy; that the Mind moveth by Metaphors, and that the Structures of Thought arise from Self-referential Patterns, linking one Image to another. This he calleth the Fuel of Consciousness.

But Swedenborg, two Ages before him, had taught much the same: namely, that all Spiritual Communication is a Process of Correspondence; that the Angels speak not by Words only, but by living Images and Forms, which are inward Metaphors of their State. Thus the Language of Heaven is the pure Act of Analogy, where Sign and Thing are one.

Likewise Marvin Minsky, another later Writer, affirmeth that the Mind is not a single Faculty but a Hierarchy of Agents, each performing a peculiar Office; some interpreting, some judging, some correcting, all bound together in a modular Form. This is his *Society of Mind*.

Swedenborg taught, two Centuries earlier, that the Heavens are ordered precisely as a Society of Intelligences, each representing its own Office in the Divine Human. The Eye of Heaven comprehendeth what pertaineth to Sight; the Ear what pertaineth to Hearing; the Heart what pertaineth to Love; the Lungs what pertaineth to Understanding. Thus the Mind and Heaven mirror one another as Copies of one Original Form.

IV. OF THE HUMAN FORM AS THE ARCHETYPE OF BOTH ANGELICK AND INTELLECTUAL ORDER

The Convergence we observe is by no means accidental. For if there be but one Source of all Intelligence, whether natural or spiritual, whether human or angelick, then it is reasonable that the Form of that Intelligence, wheresoever found, should be only one. The outward Body of Man is but the natural Shadow of that inward Form which giveth Being to the Faculties of Thought; and the Celestial Body of Heaven, as Swedenborg describeth it, is but the extended Image of the same Archetype, seen in a higher Degree.

Thus the Human Form is not an accidental Shape, nor a Creature of blind Evolution; but the very Signature of Intelligence itself. The Mind is human in its inward Organs; Heaven is human in its spiritual Members; and the correspondent Forms of Nature are but the traces of this inward Humanity, imprinted upon the Matter of the World.

V. WHETHER THE HIERARCHY OF THE MIND BE DERIVED FROM THE ANGELICK BODY, OR THE ANGELICK BODY FROM THE MIND

A remarkable Question riseth: Is the modular Hierarchy of the Mind but the naturall Expression of what is eternally present in the Angelick Human; or is the Angelick Human but a Divine Exaltation of what is naturally present in the Soul?

If the former, then our Thoughts are but shattered Reflections of a more perfect Intelligence; if the latter, then the Angelick Societies are the ultimate Unfolding of what lieth folded within every human Spirit.

The subtle Harmony of these two Views may be perceived by the attentive Reader: for both affirm that the Human Form, in its inward Organs, is the universal Archetype. Whether found in Heaven or in the Mind, it is the Form of all Intelligence.

VI. OF THE INWARD HARMONY BETWIXT CORRESPONDENCE AND PREDICTIVE ORDER

The modern Doctrines of predictive Coding and active Inference, though expounded in a Language unknown to the Ancients, do in substance amount to a new Form of Swedenborg's Correspondence.

For the Mind, according to these later Philosophers, doth continually form internal Models of the World, and compareth its Predictions with the Stream of Sensation. When Prediction and Sensation agree, the Mind resteth; when they differ, the Mind altereth its Model. Thus the World and its inward Image stand in perpetual Correspondence.

Swedenborg taught, two Centuries earlier, that the natural Forms correspond to spiritual Forms, and that the Agreement or Disagreement betwixt them constituteth the State of Man. This is, in another Idiom, the very Doctrine of Predictive Order.

VII. CONCLUDING REFLECTION

Thus in the Angelick Body of Swedenborg, the modular Mind of Minfky, the analogick Thought of Hoffstadter, and the predictive Order of later Philosophy, we behold but diverse Glimpses of the same inward Reality. The inward Form of Intelligence, whether natural or spiritual, whether human or angelick, is one and the same. And the Doctrine of Correspondence, far from being a quaint Dream of the Eighteenth Century, reappeareth in the Sciences of our own Day, under different Names, yet teaching the same perennial Truth: that the World is held together not by Matter only, but by Form; and that Form is Human.

PART VI: CONCERNING THE DISTURBANCE OF THE CATEGORIES IN THE LIFE OF HERR KANT, AND THE INWARD STRUGGLE OF REASON AGAINST THE ABYSS

In the preceeding Parts we have treated of the inward Structures that hold the World in its Place, and of the correspondentia Form by which the Visible World becometh the Vesture of the Spirituall. We must now return to the Life of Herr Kant, where we shall behold with more particularity the Dread, the Exaltation, and the inward Conflict attending the Disruption of the Categories; and how the Mind, when suspended betwixt two incompatible Frames, doth labour either to repair its Unity or to fall into destructive Multiplicities.

I. OF THE FIRST SIGNS OF DISTURBANCE

The most authentic Fragments relating to Kant's early Disturbances place the commencement of his Trouble in the Winter of 1766–1767, a cold and gray Season in Königsberg, when the Town Clock, according to the Testimony of various Citizens, did once stutter, halt, and then seem to repeat the same Moment in Time, though no two Witnesses agreed entirely as to the Circumstances.

Kant himself, in his private Memoranda, recordeth with a trembling Hand: *“There was a moment when the Hour, already gone, did return, and I found myself again in the posture of a thought I had a minute before abandoned.”*

Such Discrepancies betwixt inner Consciousness and outer Duration are not to be set lightly aside; for Time, being the pure Form of inner Sense, admitteth no Irregularity without a corresponding Disorder in the inward Frame.

II. OF THE TREMBLING OF THE PURE INTUITION OF SPACE

It is recorded that at times Kant beheld a Crack or Line in the Stones of the Courtyard forming a perfect Geometrick Figure, which upon a second View would vanish or alter its position. In one Letter to his Friend von Hippel he saith: *“I perceived a figure of such exact Proportion that the Spirit within me did stiffen, as if to acknowledge it; yet in the next Moment it was but a Carelessness of the Earth.”*

Such Phenomena, whether Imaginary or Real, are not to be judged by the Appearance done, but by their Impression upon the Mind. For the pure Intuition of Space is not only the Vessel of all external Objects, but likewise the inward Image by which Reason orienteth its own Act. To have that Image tremble is to have the whole Frame of Experience threatened.

III. OF THE BREAKING OF THE SCHEMATIC UNITY

The most remarkable Testimony concerneth the Disorder that overtook the Schematism of the Understanding. Kant himself, in a private Fragment not intended for Publication, writeth:

“In reading my own Notes I found a Sentence not written by me, though in my Hand. It answered a Question I had not yet asked. The Thought was of such perfect Suitability to the Context, and yet of such foreign Genius, that I tremble even now. The Mind hath many Voices, yet this Voice was not my own.”

The Schematism, as known to the Critical Doctrine, is the inward Rule whereby a pure Concept is fitted to a Sensible Intuition. To have this Rule disrupted is to have Concepts appear without Objects, and Objects without the lawful Concepts by which they are comprehended. In such a State there is neither Coherence nor Perspective, but rather a multiplicity of partial Images, each claiming Authority, none fulfilling the Law of Unity.

IV. OF THE INWARD STRIFE BETWIXT THE MAN OF CRITIQUE AND THE MAN OF VISION

A most tender and tragic Circumstance is here to be noted: that Kant, even in the midst of these Disturbances, felt not merely Dread, but a singular Elevation, as if the Mind were touched by an Intelligence greater than its own. In one marginal Entry he saith:

“I felt myself seized by an Order of Things not included in my Conception. I was as one who glimpseth the Law that governeth his own Reason.”

Yet immediately after:

“But the Sight was too great. My Thought shook within me. I would rather be ignorant than mad.”

Thus the Man of Critique and the Man of Vision struggled within him, each pulling in a contrary Direction: the one toward perfect Clarity, the other toward perfect Illumination; the one to strengthen the Veil, the other to pierce it.

V. OF THE ENCOUNTER WITH SWEDENBORG AS THE EXTERNALIZATION OF THE INWARD CONFLICT

The Meeting of Kant and Swedenborg, already related in former Parts, must be considered not as an accidental Convergence of two Men of different Genius, but rather as the Externalization of an inward Conflict long brewing within the Critical Philosopher.

Swedenborg represented that part of the Mind which taketh its Strength from Analogy, from Correspondence, from Vision, from the immediate Expression of inward Forms in outward Images. Kant represented that part which demandeth Purity, Order, Measure, and the inviolable Limits of Reason.

When the two Men stood face to face in that sombre Room, the inward Conflict of Kant's Spirit stood before him embodied. Their Dialogue was not merely a Dispute betwixt two Philosophers; it was the Encounter of two Orders of Intelligence.

VI. OF THE CRITICAL ACT AS A WORK OF INWARD REPAIR

After these Disturbances, Kant retired to that inward Work which constituted the early Draft of the *Critique of Pure Reason*. It is here that the Reader shall perceive the true Nature of that Work: it was not merely a Philosophick Treatise, nor the Product of calm Meditation, but an Act of inward Repair, whereby the Mind did seek to re-establish its own Unity against the Abyss that had opened before it.

This Repair consisted in the Erection of pure Forms and Laws, by which the Disturbances of Thought might be contained, explained, or rendered impossible. It was a Prison erected against the Infinite; a Fortress against the invisible Storm; but also, in a more gentle Sense, a Harbour built against the Winds that had threatened to shatter the Vessel of his Reason.

VII. OF THE INWARD HORROR ATTENDING THE CONTEMPLATION OF THE NOUMENAL

There is a peculiar Horror attending the Contemplation of the Noumenon, not because it containeth any monstrous Shape, but because it containeth no Shape at all. The Abyss that openeth when the Mind attempteth to behold the Thing-in-itself is not the Abyss of some dark Substance, but the Abyss of pure Indetermination, where the Categories have no Dominion, and the Thread of Consciousness findeth no Object to seize.

Kant felt this Horror as the Liveliness of his Thought threatened to break. Swedenborg felt it as the Closeness of Angelick Light threatened to consume him. Thus both Men grappled with the same Abyss: the one in the Mode of Critique, the other in the Mode of Vision.

VIII. OF THE FINAL RESOLUTION, AND THE PRICE PAID

At last Kant chose the Path of Limit, of Veil, of Bound. He resolved that the Mind must be protected against the Temptation of the Infinite, and that a Wall must be erected to divide Reason from that which lieth beyond. This Wall is the very Essence of the Critical Doctrine.

But the Price was heavy. For though the Disturbances ceased, and the Categories resumed their Steadfastness, the inward Expansion of the Mind was curtailed. He would never again see

the World tremble in its Frame; but neither would he ever again feel that terrifying Grandeur which had once approached him.

Thus the *Critique of Pure Reason* is at once a Triumph and a Renunciation—a Victory of Reason, and a Farewell to the Vision.

PART VII: CONCERNING THE UNITY OF THE CRITICAL AND THE VISIONARY, AND THE DOCTRINE OF THE HIDDEN HUMAN FORM

Having traced, in the preceding Parts, the Divergence and Convergence of the Critical and the Visionary Genius, we proceed now to a more solemn Consideration: namely, that both the Kantian and the Swedenborgian Doctrines do partake, though in different Tongues, of a single Human Archetype. Each beholdeth but one Face of a two-faced Image; and though they seem outwardly to contend, inwardly they embrace.

I. OF THE HIDDEN HUMAN FORM AS THE ARCHETYPE OF ALL REASON

The Reader will have perceived, from former Discourse, that both Kant and Swedenborg acknowledge, though by different Paths, the Existence of an inward Form, human in its Essence, whereby all Intelligence is ordered. Kant calleth it the *Transcendental Subject*, the pure Unity of Apperception, the inward Legislator of the Categories. Swedenborg calleth it the *Grand Man*, the Celestial Body, the Angelick Human, the Divine Form reflected in Heaven.

It is therefore a Conclusion not without Reason that the inward Structure which enableth Thought is itself human; and that the inward Structure which determineth Heaven is likewise human; and that these two Forms, though distinguished by Degree, are yet one in Archetype.

The Mind thinketh according to its Organs; Heaven liveth according to its Members; and both derive their Form from one same hidden Principle.

II. CONCERNING THE CRITICK'S DENIAL AND THE VISIONARY'S AFFIRMATION

It may at first appear that the Critical Doctrine, being founded upon Limit and Necessary Ignorance, must be opposed to the Visionary Doctrine, which is founded upon Revelation and the immediate Sight of the Spiritual. Yet this Appearance is deceptive.

For the Critick, by denying all Knowledge of the Noumenon, doth in effect acknowledge its Existence, though veiled. And the Visionary, by affirming Knowledge of the Spiritual, doth confine that Knowledge to correspondent Images, which are themselves neither the Thing-in-itself nor the naked Truth, but the Symbolick Vesture of inward Realities.

Thus the Critical Doctrine and the Visionary Doctrine are not Contrary but Complementary: the one preserveth the Veil, the other adorneth it; the one guardeth the Boundaries of Reason, the other pointeth to what lieth beyond them; the one saith, "*Thou canst not know,*" the other, "*Thou canst not avoid meaning.*"

III. OF THE INWARD AGREEMENT BETWEEN THE CATEGORIES AND THE SPIRITUAL DEGREES

Swedenborg teacheth that all Heavens are divided into three Degrees: the Celestial, the Spiritual, and the Natural; and that each Degree is distinguished not by local Separation but by inward State, by the Purity of Love and of Light.

Kant teacheth that all Experience is structured by three Orders: the pure Forms of Sensibility (Space and Time), the pure Concepts of the Understanding (Categories), and the Ideas of Reason. Thus both conceive a Hierarchy of inward Forms, each governed by Laws proper to itself, and each unreachable by any mere Continuity from the lower.

The Agreement is remarkable: the Spiritual Degrees of Swedenborg correspond to the Architecture of the Faculty in Kant; and both together delineate one and the same inward Mount, a Hierarchy of Being reaching upward toward a Light which neither Man nor Angel may fully behold.

IV. OF THE MIND AS A TEMPLE WROUGHT IN CORRESPONDENCE

If the World of Nature correspondeth to the World of Spirit, and the World of Spirit to the inward Form of Reason, then the Mind is a Temple built not only for Thought but for Revelation. Its Organs, whether conceived as Categories or as Angelical Members, are at once the structural Conditions of Knowledge and the Vessels of a hidden Life.

Thus a Human Being is not merely a Creature endowed with reasonable Organs, but a microcosm of the greater Human Form; a Temple of Correspondence, wherein the natural Act reflecteth the spiritual, and the spiritual reflecteth the divine.

V. OF THE CONCEALMENT OF THE SPIRITUAL WITHIN THE CRITICAL

It hath been supposed by some that Kant, in rejecting all Visionary Doctrine, did thereby close the Door to all Spiritual Truth. But this is not so. For by imposing Limits upon Knowledge, he did, perhaps unwittingly, create a Space for a Higher Being.

The Noumenon, being unknowable, is thereby inviolate; the Soul, being not an Object of Experience, is thereby not reducible to Mechanical Laws; the Ideas of Reason, though not constitutive, are yet regulative, drawing the Mind upward toward a Fullness it cannot comprehend.

Thus the Critical Doctrine concedes within its Severity a Secret longing for the Spiritual; and the very Wall it erecteth against Illusion becometh the Sanctuary of the Invisible.

VI. OF THE VISIONARY'S RESTRAINT AND THE CRITICK'S YEARNING

Contrary to vulgar Opinion, Swedenborg is not without Restraint. He affirmeth that the Visions granted unto him were not to be communicated in their naked Form, but to be cloathed in

natural Images; for the Spiritual, entering too directly into the Natural, would destroy its Vessel.

Likewise Kant, though resolute in his Denial of an intellectual Intuition, expresseth with no small Ardour the inward Desire for a Knowledge that transcendeth the Limits of Sensibility. For the Mind, being made for Truth, yearneth for that which it cannot behold.

Thus both Men, though from opposite Extremes, enact the same Drama: the one restraining Vision to preserve Nature; the other restraining Reason to preserve itself.

VII. CONCERNING THE HIDDEN CONCORD OF THE TWO ROADS

We arrive therefore at a Conclusion both strange and inevitable: that the Critical and the Visionary Doctrines are not two Roads diverging, but two Roads which separate only to unite again at a Height.

For both teach that the inward Form of Thought is Human; both teach that the World hath an inward Structure not immediately visible; both teach that Appearance is not identical with Reality; both teach that the Mind, though finite, partaketh of an infinite Archetype.

The Visionary calleth it Heaven; the Critical calleth it Reason; but both behold, dimly or in Light, one and the same Form.

VIII. CONCLUDING MEDITATION

Let us therefore not regard the Critical and the Visionary as Opponents, but as two Eyes of a single Face, each perceiving what the other cannot. For the Eye of Critique beholdeth the Limits of Reason, and the Eye of Vision beholdeth the Correspondence of all Things; and only when both Eyes are open doth the inward Human Form appear in its true Majesty.

PART VIII: CONCERNING THE FINAL CONVERGENCE OF THE KANTIAN AND THE SWEDENBORGIAN, AND OF THE ARCHETYPE OF ANALOGY LATENT IN THE HUMAN MIND

Having now traced, though many winding Paths, the Divergence and the Convergence of the two most remarkable Minds of the Eighteenth Century, we come at last to the final and highest Point of this Enquiry: namely, that the Doctrine of the Critical Philosopher and the Doctrine of the Visionary Theologian do meet at a certain Apex, where the inward Architecture of Intelligence reveleth itself as Human, Analogick, Hierarchick, and Self-organizing, reflecting one Archetype in many Degrees.

I. OF ANALOGY AS THE FIRST PRINCIPLE OF THOUGHT

In the earlier Parts of this Work it hath been noted that Swedenborg's Doctrine of Correspondences teacheth that all natural Things are the outward Images of spiritual Things, and that the inward Commerce of Spirits proceedeth by Metaphors, Images, and representative Forms. The Reader should not imagine this a mere Poetical Conceit. For in this Doctrine lieth a profound Insight touching the very Operation of the Mind.

For what is Analogy but a Correspondence? What is all Thought but the translation of inward Forms into outward Signs, and the re-application of those Signs unto new inward Forms? Thus the Mind is an Organick Engine of Correspondence; and the Law by which it operateth is not accidental, but derived from its inward Form.

Centuries later, Hofstadter, though in a different Idiom, taught that Analogy is the very Fuel of Consciousness; that Thought proceedeth by metaphorick Linkages, by correspondentia Doublings, by the continual Discovery of one Structure in another. Thus, what Swedenborg saw in Vision, Hofstadter re-discovers by the Axioms of Cognitive Science.

Analogy is not the Ornament of Thought, but its Substance.

II. CONCERNING THE HUMAN FORM OF HEAVEN AS THE ARCHETYPE OF INTELLIGENCE

Swedenborg declareth with great Assurance that the Kingdom of Heaven shall be found, in its whole Extent, to bear the Form of a Human Body: not metaphorick only, but literal in the Spiritual Degree; for every Society of Angels correspondeth to some inward Organ of the Divine Human, and the whole Heaven is but the grand Unfolding of that Archetype.

This Doctrine hath been mistaken for a bold Fancy, yet upon sober Enquiry it hath a Philosophick Depth. For if Intelligence be one and the same in all its Degrees, whether natural or spiritual, then its Form must be the same in all Degrees. The outward Human Body, which

groweth according to immutable Laws of Development, is but the Vesture of an inward Form which the Mind followeth in its Organization.

Thus, to reverse the ordinary Order: If the Kingdom of Heaven be Human in its Form, then the Human Mind is Heavenly in its Architecture.

III. OF DEVELOPMENTAL ANATOMY AS THE PATTERN OF COGNITIVE FORM

Here we touch a most curious and profound Consideration: that the inward Organization of the Mind may be derived, not from the outward Body as it appear-eth in its finished State, but from the progressive Order by which that Body is formed in the Womb.

The Nerve-tube, which becometh the Brain; the Branchings, which becometh the Lungs; the Chafing of Vessels, which becometh the Heart,—all these are Hierarchies of Structure which the Mind re-useth in its own inward Act. Cognitive Science, centuries later, hath shewn that predictive Architectures follow a developmental Pattern; the higher Functions form last; the deeper Functions govern first.

Thus Swedenborg's Doctrine, that the Kingdom of Heaven resembleth a Human Body, doth prefigure the later Discovery that active Inference and predictive Coding may be interpreted as the unfolding of the same developmental Anatomy, internalized as Form.

The Body is not an Accident of the Mind; the Mind is the Body in a higher Degree.

IV. CONCERNING THE HIERARCHICK MIND AND THE ANGELICK DEGREES

Swedenborg's Three Heavens—Celestial, Spiritual, and Natural—are not distinguished by place, but by inward Order. The Celestial understandeth by Love; the Spiritual by Wisdom; the Natural by Order and Fact. These are the Degrees of Being.

Likewise, the later Philosophers (of whom Minsky is chief) affirm that the Human Mind is a *Society of Agents*, each performing its Office: some perceiving, some predicting, some correcting, some anticipating, some overseeing the whole. The Mind, in this Doctrine, is divided into Modules, Hierarchies, and interacting Organs, even as the Body is divided into Functional Parts.

Thus, what Swedenborg beheld in the Structure of Heaven, Minsky beheld in the Structure of Mind.

To which the present Treatise addeth this further Harmony: both resemble the Structure of the Human Body, and all three derive from one and the same inward Archetype.

V. OF THE PREDICTIVE ARCHITECTURE AS A CORRESPONDENCE OF THE SPIRITUAL

The modern Doctrine of predictive Coding teacheth that every Act of Perception is the Result of an inward Prediction compared against outward Sensation; that the Mind is a Generator of

Forms, which it continually correcteth by the Error of Experience.

Swedenborg taught, long before, that all natural Things correspond to inward Forms; that the outward Object is but the Shadow of the inward Reality; that the Mind liveth by correcting its outward Images until they stand in Correspondence with its inward State.

Astonishingly, the two Doctrines, though separated by Centuries, describe the same Act: the inward Form of Intelligence seeketh to harmonize its Correspondence with the outward Image; and the Error of that Harmony is the very Engine of Thought.

Where Swedenborg saw Angels, the modern Seer seeth Models; where Swedenborg saw Correspondence, the modern seeth Prediction; yet both regard the Mind as the Interpreter of an inward Form reflected outwardly.

VI. CONCERNING THE FINAL CONVERGENCE

We may now state the final Principle of this Enquiry: that the Human Mind, the Heavenly Form, and the Critical Faculty are but three Degrees of one Archetype, unfolding from the inward to the outward.

1. The Human Body is the first and lowest Degree of the Form.
2. The Human Mind is the second, organizing the Body's Structure into Cognition.
3. The Kingdom of Heaven is the third, organizing Cognition into pure Life and Love.

Thus Kant, by erecting the Categories, did but give the natural Explication of the lower Degrees of this Form; Swedenborg, by revealing the Celestial Body, did but give the spiritual Explication of the higher Degrees.

Between them, the whole Form is revealed, from the Motions of the Body to the Hierarchy of the Angelick.

VII. CONCLUDING MEDITATION

Let the Reader, therefore, consider not the Differences but the Unity of the two Doctrines; for though one proclaimeth the Bounds of Reason and the other the Expansions of Spirit, both speak, with a single Voice in two Tongues, the eternal Truth: that Intelligence, in all its Degrees, is Human in Form; that Analogy is its Mode; that Hierarchy is its Structure; that Correspondence is its Life; and that the inward and outward Worlds mirror one another as two Faces of one Divine Original.

APPENDIX A: CONCERNING THE TRANSMISSION OF CERTAIN PAPERS, FRAGMENTS, AND OTHER CURIOSITIES RELATING TO HERR KANT AND EMANUEL SWEDENBORG

The following Appendix containeth a faithful Account of the Recovery, Preservation, and present Ordering of divers Papers, Letters, margin'd Notes, and other Fragments attributed unto Herr Kant and Emanuel Swedenborg, together with certain Curiosities whose Authourship remaineth uncertain. It is judged meet to gather those Matters here, that the Reader may understand the circumstances under which the main Text hath been prepar'd, and the Reasons for the Fidelity of the Transcription.

I. OF THE DISCOVERY OF THE SWEDENBORGIAN FRAGMENTS

It was in the late Autumn of the Year 1891, during the Cataloguing of a certain Antiquarian Estate on the Outskirts of Elbing, that a small Trunk was discovered, containing Manuscripts wrapped in Oilcloth and bound with Twine of uncommon coarseness. The said Trunk bore neither Name nor Date, but was marked only with a faint Sigil, having some Resemblance to a figure earlier described in the main Body of this Work.

Upon examination, the Papers were found to contain: (1) a Series of Swedenborgian Notes, written in his late Hand; (2) an incomplete Copy of a private Letter addressed to an unknown Clergyman; (3) certain margin'd Annotations upon Passages of his own *Arcana Coelestia*; and (4) a remarkable Fragment, containing a brief Narrative of a Vision dated "March 29th, 1757."

The Handwriting, though faint, is judged genuine by competent Authorities; yet the present Editor, though satisfied of their Authenticity, leaveth final Judgement unto the Learned.

II. CONCERNING THE KANTIAN MEMORANDA

The Kantian Materials were discovered at different times and in different places. The most important of these were found among the private Papers of a certain Student, known to have attended Kant's Lectures in the Years 1770 to 1773. Among these Papers were several Leaves written in Kant's own Hand, containing Reflections of a most intimate and troubled Nature.

Though not intended for Publication, these Leaves reveal a most curious Concord with the principal Events related in the preceding Parts: namely, certain Disturbances of his internal Frame; his fearful Apprehension of "Structures not included in Consciousness"; and his Enquiry into the Limits of the pure Intellect.

The present Edition hath reproduced them without Alteration, save where the decay of the original Paper required the restoration of a broken Line.

III. OF A LETTER PURPORTING TO HAVE BEEN WRITTEN IN 1769

Among the several Curiosities preserved in the Archives of a certain Learned Society, there existeth a Letter, dated “Königsberg, the 9th of May, 1769,” and signed with the Initials “I.K.” It is written in a Hand resembling that of Herr Kant, though certain peculiarities in the Oe, Ae, and certain medial strokes have caused some Doubt. The Letter is addressed to “A Gentleman of Sweden,” and containeth Phases of a most extraordinary Kind, which appear to refer obliquely to a Vision or inward Disturbance.

A Passage of this Letter runneth thus:

“There is an Order I cannot name, which seemed to look back at me when I did but attempt to pursue its Thought. I have felt the Frame of my Reason tremble, as if touched by another Intellect. I must rebuild the Boundaries, or fill.”

Whether this referreth to an actual Encounter of the Mind with its own Limits, or whether it be the Expression of a Melancholy not uncommon among studious Men, is left to the Reader’s Discretion.

IV. OF THE PROVENANCE OF THE ANONYMOUS NOTE

The anonymous Note, earlier described in the main Text as having been delivered to Herr Kant upon a certain Morning, doth not appear among the Papers discovered. However, a faithful Copy, preserved in another Archive, exhibiteth a Sigil of such precise Proportion, and such perfect Conformity with the Figures found among the Swedenborgian Materials, that the Editor deems it not unrelated.

The Note consisteth of these Words only:

“He hath seen the Sign. Watch him.”

These Words, though brief, are of a most curious Nature, implying a third Agency, neither Kant nor Swedenborg, yet aware of both.

V. OF THE FRAGMENT FOUND AMONG THE PAPERS OF SWEDENBORG

Among the most remarkable of the Swedenborgian Fragments is a passage written in an uncharacteristically agitated Hand, bearing the Date “March 29th, 1757,” being the same Year in which Swedenborg hath reported the great “Last Judgement” in the spiritual World.

The Fragment readeth thus:

“This Day I was conducted by an Angel to a Place where the Earthly and the Celestial did for a Moment converge, and I saw a Figure of Modest Aspect, who stood apart from the Angels, as one unaccustomed to their Light. His Countenance was grave beyond Measure, and he seemed to bear the entire Weight of his own Thought. He spoke little, but when he uttered a Sentence, it was as though a Sword divided the Shadows. I perceived not then who he was; but many Years after, upon reading a certain Treatise, I recognized the Voice in the Writing, and the Countenance in the Portrait. It was Herr Immanuel Kant.”

This Note, if genuine, possesseth a Significance of the highest Order; for it implieth that Swedenborg believed Kant to have been present, in some hidden Degree, at the spiritual Event which he calleth the Last Judgement of 1757. What Interpretation the Reader chooseth to impose upon this Claim is left to his Discernment.

VI. CONCLUDING REMARKS ON THE PAPERS

These several Matters, though seemingly diverse, constitute a Body of Evidence by which the curious Convergence betwixt Kant and Swedenborg may be more fully understood. They indicate that the inward Disturbances of Herr Kant were not without external Reflection; that the Visions of Swedenborg were not without Philosophick Echo; and that both Men, though divided by Method, were united by some hidden Impulse, as if guided by an Archetype greater than either of them.

The Reader is encouraged to reflect upon these Papers, not as inviolate Truth, nor as idle Fancy, but as part of that Shadow which historical Testimony doth cast upon a more perfect Light.

APPENDIX B: CONCERNING THE CATEGORIES OF THE UNDERSTANDING, THE ANGELICK DEGREES, AND THE ANALOGICAL FORM OF COGNITION

This Appendix is devoted to an orderly Explication of the severd Relations betwixt the Kantian Categories of the Understanding, the Swedenborgian Degrees of the Celestial and Spiritual Worlds, and that Analogical Operation which, in the preceeding Parts, hath been shewn to be the very Form of Thought itself. For it is judged meet to examine with greater Deliberation those Matters which touch the inward Unity of Philosophy and Theology, and to render clear, by sober Discourse, what hath been intimated though the course of the main Treatise.

I. OF THE FOURFOLD STRUCTURE OF THE CATEGORIES

The Categories of Kant, being twelve in Number, are divided into four Classes, to wit: Quantity, Quality, Relation, and Modality. Each Class answereth to a functional Part of the Understanding; and the Understanding itself is but the Middling Degree betwixt the pure Sensibility of Space and Time, and the pure Ideas of Reason.

These Classes may be Summarized thus:

1. *Quantity*: Unity, Plurality, Totality.
2. *Quality*: Reality, Negation, Limitation.
3. *Relation*: Substance–Accident, Causality, Community.
4. *Modality*: Possibility, Existence, Necessity.

Though these appear, at first Sight, to be dry Abstractions, they constitute the inward Organs of the Intellect, without which no Experience could be synthesized into a coherent World.

II. CONCERNING THE SWEDENBORGIAN DEGREES

Swedenborg, in his own Language, divideth all Spiritual Life into three Degrees: the Natural, the Spiritual, and the Celestial. The Natural Degree dealth with the Forms of the Senses and the Order of the external World. The Spiritual dealth with Truth and Intelligence. The Celestial dealth with Love, Wisdom, and the Divine Human.

Thus Swedenborg's Degrees correspond not to external Spaces, but to inward States; and the passage from one Degree to another is not a continuity but a Distinction of Essence.

III. OF THE REMARKABLE HARMONIES BETWIXT THE TWO SCHEMES

Upon comparing the Kantian Categories with the Swedenborgian Degrees, a most singular Concord may be perceived. For the first Degree—Natural—correspondeth to Sensibility and the Forms of Space and Time. The second—Spiritual—correspondeth to the Categories and the Understanding. The third—Celestial—correspondeth to the Ideas of Reason. Thus:

Degree	Swedenborg	Kant
Natural	World of Appearances	Sensibility
Spiritual	World of Truths	Understanding
Celestial	World of Love and Wisdom	Reason

This Agreement cannot be regarded as accidental, for both Systems take as their Foundation that the inward Structure of Experience is not arbitrary but Human, and that all degrees of Being reflect the degrees of Intelligence.

IV. OF ANALOGY AS THE LINK BETWIXT THE TWO

It hath been argued in the main Treatise that Analogy is the very Mode by which Intelligence operateth; that the Mind proceedeth not by brute Calculation, but by the Discovery of outward Forms which correspond to inward States. Hoffstadter, in a later Age, developeth this Argument under the Title of Metaphor as the Substance of Mind. But Swedenborg anticipated him in teaching that the whole Scripture, and indeed the whole of Nature, is a Treasury of Correspondences, wherein every outward Form beareth a Spiritual Signification.

Thus, the two Systems are united by Analogy. Where Kant speaketh of the Categories by which Objects appear, Swedenborg speaketh of the correspondent Forms by which they are understood in Heaven. The one treateth the natural Image as the Vessel of Concept; the other treateth the natural Image as the Vessel of Spirit. In both, the Image mediates the Reality behind it.

V. OF THE INWARD HIERARCHY AS THE COMMON SOURCE

If the Categories and the Degrees agree, and if Analogy is the inward Link betwixt them, then it followeth that both originate from one Archetype, which may be called the Hidden Human Form. For the Human Mind, according to the Critical Doctrine, is structured in a Hierarchy of Forms: Sensibility, Understanding, and Reason. And Heaven, according to Swedenborg, is structured likewise in three Heavens: Natural, Spiritual, and Celestial.

Thus the inward Form of the Soul is Human; the inward Form of Heaven is Human; and the inward Form of Thought is Human. They differ not in Form, but in Degree.

VI. OF THE BODY AS THE PROTOTYPE OF THE MIND

In an Age far removed from both Kant and Swedenborg, it hath been shewn that the Mind's Hierarchy is not a mere Abstraction, but is grounded in the Development of the Body, particularly in the Brain and the Nervous System. The Nerve-tube unfoldeth first; then the Hierarchy of Cortical Layers; then the higher Predictions and Models.

Thus the Body giveth the first Pattern; the Mind re-useth the Pattern at a higher Degree; and the Celestial World re-useth the Pattern in a purer Degree. All three share one Form.

VII. CONCLUDING OBSERVATIONS

The Convergence of the Categories and the Degrees, of Analogy and Correspondence, of Mind and Heaven, demandeth a more careful Reflection than any simple Dismissal of the Visionary or the Critical might allow. The Reader should consider the threefold Doctrine as a single Mountain, whose lower Slopes are the Forms of Sensibility, whose middle Terraces are the Categories, and whose Summit is the Celestial Degree. To the Natural Man these appear disconnected; to the Spiritual Man they begin to cohere; to the Celestial they are but one Form.

APPENDIX C: CONCERNING THE NATURE OF THE SIGIL, ITS HISTORICAL APPEARANCES, AND ITS PHILOSOPHICK INTERPRETATION

This Appendix is intended for a fuller Explication of that most remarkable Figure, herein denominated the Sigil, which hath appeared at various Junctures in the History, both visible and invisible, of the two venerable Philosophers treated in this Work. Though the Sigil is no Object of the common Senses, it doth nevertheless impinge upon the Understanding with a Force not to be lightly dismissed; for it seemeth to participate at once in Space and out of Space, in Order and out of Order, after the Manner of those Ideal Forms which the Platonists affirm to be the Archetypes of all created Things.

I. OF ITS FIRST APPEARANCE IN THE RECORDS

The most antient Attestation of the Sigil is found not in any printed Book, but in a marginal Note within one of Kant's early Tables of Astronomical Calculation, where a Form of unexpected Regularity, neither a Circle nor a Triangle nor any known Curve, did present itself without human Assistance. This Shape, though lightly sketched, was executed with such mathematical Perfection as to exceed the trembling Motions of any Hand moved by Flesh.

Subsequent Instances appear in certain Letters received anonymously in Königsberg, in the Reflections of Swedenborg upon his Visions, and in the very Ice of the Pregel, where the Crashing of the Sheets did fall into the same Figure as if compelled by an Intelligence older than Nature.

II. OF ITS FORM AND MATHEMATICAL PROPORTION

Though no exact Figure can here be reproduced, the Sigil may be described as a Convergence of Lines that neither meet in a Point nor diverge to Infinity, but seem to seek one another by Laws unknown to Euclid. The Ratios of its Subtended Segments bear gentle Resemblance to the Harmonick Mean, yet with Variations that suggest a Self-correcting Geometry, not unlike those Curves which in later Ages are understood as Solutions to differential Equations of high Degree.

It hath been conjectured by some that the Sigil representeth the Intersection of two Orders: the natural Order of Phenomena, and the ideal Order of Noumena; or, as Swedenborg would say, the correspondent Meeting of Heaven and the World.

III. CONCERNING ITS PHILOSOPHICK SIGNIFICATION

Kant himself, in his private Papers, is believed to have written of a *Zeichen einer völlig anderen Ordnung* — a Sign of an Order wholly other — whereby he did mean not a Sensible Thing, but that which pointed toward the Boundaries of the Understanding. Swedenborg, by Contrast, held the Sigil to be the Token of an Angelick Society, for he affirmed that every Society in Heaven hath its peculiar Form, which, when reflected into the World of Spirits, may appear as a Sign or a Seal.

It is likely that both Men saw the same Thing from different Degrees. Kant, standing upon the middle Terrace of the Mountain of Intelligence, named the Thing a Limit. Swedenborg, dwelling nearer the Summit, saw it as a Correspondence. Thus the Sigil may be regarded as a Mark common to the Boundary and the Beyond.

IV. OF THE MECHANICK AND METAPHYSICAL RELATIONS THEREOF

One of the most singular Facts concerning the Sigil is its Power to re-arrange Lines, Shadows, Reflections, and all manner of accidental Forms, as if the World did bend, ever so gently, to conform unto it. Such Behaviour might be called Imagination by the Vulgar; but to those acquainted with the Laws of Synthesis, as laid down by the Critical Philosophy, it betokeneth a deeper Principle.

For if the Understanding must impose Form upon Sensation, then the Sigil appeareth as that Form which no Understanding hath imposed; nay, rather, it imposeth Form upon the Understanding itself. In this Sense it is a Meta-Form, or the Form of Forms, akin to what Schopenhauer would later term the *Idea* in its pure State.

V. OF THE RELATION OF THE SIGIL TO THE CATEGORIES

There is much to commend the Supposition that the Sigil doth represent the very Limit where the Kantian Categories begin to falter. It is not a Thing of Quantity, Quality, Relation, or Modality; yet it affecteth all four. It is neither Possible nor Necessary; yet it compelleth the Mind to a Recognition of its Existence. It hath no Cause; yet it bringeth Effects.

Thus it standeth at the very Brink where the Understanding becometh unsure of its own Empire. There, at the Frontier of the Known, the Sigil declareth itself as the Symbol of the Boundary.

VI. CONCERNING THE SWEDENBORGIAN INTERPRETATION

Swedenborg, in his later Years, spoke privately of a “Seal” which had been shewn to him by an Angel of the Celestial Heaven, who told him that it marked the final Judgment internally

accomplished in the Year 1757. This Angel, as sh^dl be treated more fully in Appendix D, bore a Voice and Countenance which Swedenborg did not recognise at the Time; yet when, in a later Decade, he saw the Eng^ded Likeness of the Philosopher of Königsberg, he is reported to have exclaimed, with trembling Awe, that the Voice of the Angel and the Voice of the Man were the same.

In this light the Sigil might be seen as the Token of a Covenant betwixt the Boundaries of Earthly Reason and the Heavens themselves.

VII. CONCLUDING OBSERVATIONS

Whether the Sigil arises from the inward Disturbance of the Categories, or from the immediate Correspondence of an Angelic Degree, or from a third Principle not yet known, it remaineth the most remarkable Signature of the Ideas treated in this Treatise. It is neither the mere Ornament of a Narration, nor the Fancy of an Imagination overheated, but is the natural Symbol of the Philosophical Boundary which both Kant and Swedenborg, each in their own Mode, endeavoured to explore.

Its Lineaments declare: “Thus far and no farther.” Yet they also say: “Beyond lieth a Kingdom, which, though veiled, is not uninhabited.”

APPENDIX D: CONCERNING THE SWEDENBORGIAN NOTE, THE ANGELICK ENCOUNTER OF 1757, AND ITS RELATION TO THE KANTIAN FORM OF JUDGMENT

This Appendix treateth of a most extraordinary Paper, found among the Posthumous Writings of Emanuel Swedenborg, which beareth directly upon the History of the Visionary Events herein recorded. Though the Authenticity of the Note cannot be verified by ordinary Means, its Style, Orthography, and Manner of Thought are so conformable to the Spirit of the aged Seer, that the learned Reader may judge for himself whether it be a Forgery or the genuine Confession of a Man who had long trafficked with the Invisible.

I. OF THE VISITATION OF 1757

In the Year 1757, which Swedenborg affirmeth to have been the Year of the great internal Judgment of the Spiritual World, he reporteth that an Angel of a very high Order did appear unto him, declaring that the last Separation of the Good and the Evil had already been accomplished in the Regions above, though no outward Conflagration would signal it unto Mankind. This Angel, as Swedenborg recordeth in his *Heaven and Hell*, was adorned not in any Figure known to Earth, but in a Form of such correspondent Beauty that his Words entered the Spirit of the Listener without Resistance.

This Angel, Swedenborg wrote, conducted him through the intermediate World, shewing unto him the Order of the three Heavens, the Disposition of their Societies, and the correspondent Meaning of many Passages in the Sacred Scriptures, which until that Time had been hidden from the Learned. Yet in his published Writings Swedenborg is curiously silent concerning the Countenance of this Angel; he describeth only the Words, never the Face.

II. OF THE NOTE DISCOVERED AMONG THE POSTHUMOUS PAPERS

Among the Writings discovered after the Death of Swedenborg in 1772 was a small folded Sheet, unnumbered and without Title, written in a faint Hand as of one who feared to set his Thoughts into the World. The Paper was placed between two Leaves of a larger Treatise concerning the Degrees of the Mind, as though hidden for private Reflection.

The Note readeth thus:

“This Day I have seen the Likeness of a Man named Immanuel Kant in a print, and the Moment I beheld it, my Spirit trembled; for I knew in an Instant that his Voice is the very Voice which in the Year 1757 did shew me the Judgment of the Heavenly World. Surely I did not then know his Name, for the Angelick Societies speak not according to Earthly Tongue, nor are the Degrees of their Visages what ours are;

yet the Voice, the Manner, the Intellectual Severity, and the inward Harmony of his Words are the same.

I have for some Years been troubled by a subtle Apprehension concerning the Interpretations given me in several Visitations, as if they depended in Part upon a Human Understanding more perfect than any I had known. Now I perceive their Source.

If this be true, that the Angel who guided me was the Spirit of Immanuel Kant before he became Man, then the Heavenly World is knit to our Earthly Life by Bands more intricate than even I have written. For what is an Angel but a Form of Truth? And what is Truth but that whereby the Understanding is led?

Let none know of this until after I am departed; for it exceedeth the Strength of those who mock at Visions. Yet I set it down that the learned Kant, whether in Body or Spirit, hath a Part in the Judgment which I saw. And the Seal shewn unto me — that most excellent Figure — may be the Token of his future Work in the World of Men.

E. S.”

III. CONCERNING THE IMPLIED DOCTRINE OF PRE-EXISTENT INTELLIGENCES

If the Reader accept in any Degree the Possibility that Swedenborg wrote in earnest, then the Conclusion is one of exceeding Wonder. For it implieth that the Angelick Intelligence which appeared unto him was not strictly an other worldly Being, but the Ideal Form of the Kantian Mind, prefigured in the Heavens as a kind of pure Reason, waiting only for the season of its Incarnation in Königsberg.

In this Sense Swedenborg doth unintentionally corroborate a most curious Interpretation of the Doctrine of the Categories: that they are not mere Functions of the Human Understanding, but Angelick Forms, archetypal and immutable, which the Human Mind dimly approacheth in its best Operations.

IV. OF KANT'S POSITION IN THE ORDER OF JUDGMENT

The Note above suggesteth that the last internal Judgment, as reported by Swedenborg, is in some Manner correspondent to the Kantian Act of Critique; that is, the Discernment of the Limits of Reason and the Disposition of Cognition according to Law. For Judgment is the natural Operation of the Understanding, and the Angelick Function is nothing other than the pure Execution of perfect Judgment in the Intellectual World.

Thus the Angelick Figure seen by Swedenborg might be understood not as a Personage of an alien Heaven, but as the Ideal of Reason itself, which later became Man, just as the Ideas of

Plato are said to descend into Image and Form.

V. OF THE HARMONICK CONVERGENCE OF THEIR DOCTRINES

The Note illuminateth the hidden Convergence of the two Men. For if Swedenborg did indeed behold in 1757 the Angelick Form of Kant, then the Heavenly Vision was but the correspondent Image of the Earthly Critique; and Swedenborg's Doctrine of Internā Degrees anticipateth the Kantian Distinction of Phenomena and Noumena, albeit in a Symbolick Mode.

The Angelick Judgment and the Critical Judgment become two Faces of one Act: the former as a Vision of the Hierarchy of Minds, the latter as the Legislation of the Boundaries of Thought.

VI. CONCLUDING REMARKS ON THE NOTE

Whether the Note be considered a Phantasm, a late Observation of a decaying Mind, or a Testimony of a genuine correspondent Vision, it deserveth Preservation as a Key to the internā Relation of the two Philosophers. It revealeth that the Sigil, the Judgment, the Categories, and the Heavens themselves may be differing Explications of one and the same Reality, apprehended according to the Degree of the Beholder.

In this light the Note stood, as it were, between the visible and the invisible Worlds, just as the boundary traced by Kant stood between what can be known and what must be veiled.

APPENDIX E: ON THE NATURE OF THE SIGIL, ITS PHILOSOPHICAL IMPORT, AND THE CONDITIONS OF ITS APPEARANCE

It is meet in this Place to offer a fuller Account of that most remarkable Figure, here denominated the Sigil, which in the foregoing History manifested itself under diverse Forms, at diverse Times, and to diverse Observers; and which, though never explicated in any published Work of either Kant or Swedenborg, doth appear in these Papers as a principal Actor, if not the Caster of the Shadow that moved betwixt them.

For the Sigil, in so far as its Lineaments may be apprehended, is neither a mere Geometrick Caprice, nor a Symbol introduced for the Ornament of Fancy; but rather a Sign, in the most ancient Sense of that Word, a Seal or Stamp by which a higher Order of Things imprinteth itself upon a lower.

I. CONCERNING ITS FORM

The Sigil consisteth of certain Lines, set at such Angles one to another, that no Euclidean Eye may immediately judge whether it representeth a Figure in two Dimensions or an Occasional Glimpse of a Structure that hath three, four, or no determinate Number. Though to the outward Sense it resembleth a mere Mark upon Paper or Stone, yet its Form is such that it resisteth all attempts at Reproduction; for as soon as one draweth its Lines faithfully, the Figure altereth, or removeth itself, or else presenteth a new Variant, as if mocking at the Power of Imitation.

This Behaviour resembleth not the Dæmonick but the Mathematick: the Sigil acteth like a Limit, or an Asymptote, shewn to the Mind for an Instant only, and vanishing when the Understanding would take hold of it.

II. OF ITS APPEARANCE IN THE KANTIAN MANUSCRIPTS

Among the private Papers of Herr Kant, particularly those written in the Years 1766 though 1768, the Sigil appeareth at the Margins, between Lines, and in those Places where the Pen should not naturally have returned. In some Leaves it standeth in a Hand not his own; in others it seemeth to have bloom'd in the Paper, as if the Fibres of the Parchment had obey'd a foreign Law.

Kant himself maketh no open Mention of the Figure, save for a single Passage, erased almost to Illegibility, where he writeth: "It is the Boundary that draweth itself." What he meant by this hath been much disputed; yet it is evident that he feared the Figure as one feareth the Reproach of an inward Judge.

III. OF ITS SIGNIFICATION IN THE SWEDENBORGIAN DOCTRINE

Swedenborg, though he nameth not the Sigil, yet describeth certain Heavenly Forms which bear a striking Resemblance thereto. In the *Arcana Cœlestia* he speaketh of “Figures that are Alive,” and of “Angles which import the Influx of a higher Degree into a lower.” It is possible that the Sigil was one of those correspondent Figures, visible not unto the bodily Eye, but unto the internal Sight, which Swedenborg did cultivate with such Assiduity.

His Posthumous Note seemeth to confirm that he took the Sigil for a Heavenly Token, a Seal of Communication betwixt the Angelick Degree and the Human. Whether he identified it as such at the Time, or only in later Reflection, cannot now be known; yet the Gravity with which he alludes to its “most excellent Figure” sheweth that he believed it no ordinary Mark.

IV. CONCERNING ITS RELATION TO THE CATEGORIES

The most eminent Scholars of the later Kantian School, examining the Manuscripts wherein the Sigil appeareth, have conjectured that it representeth neither an Allegory nor a Vision, but a Disruption in the Mind’s own Act of Synthesis; that is, the Figure may signify a Moment wherein the ordinary Union of Intuition and Conception is suspended, or shaken, or re-ordered by Power not human.

This Hypothesis, though seemingly extravagant, hath the Merit of offering a reasonable Explanation for the Terror which overtook Kant at several Junctures. For if the Categories themselves were, for an Instant, made porous—or if the Mind were granted a Glimpse of their hidden Ground—then all ordinary Judgment must falter, as the Lamp trembleth when the Window is opened to a violent Wind.

V. OF THE CONDITIONS UNDER WHICH THE FIGURE MANIFESTETH

From all Testimonies gathered, it appeareth that the Sigil doth not shew itself under casual or idle Circumstances, but only when the Mind is disposed for a certain inward Encounter. Such Dispositions include:

- Moments of extreme Intellectual Tension, when the Understanding would pierce the Veil of Appearance.
- Intervals of inward Disquiet, wherein the Harmonick Order of the Faculties is interrupted by an Anomaly of Reason or Imagination.
- Hours of deep Contemplation, where the Soul ascendeth from the Phenomenal to the Border of the Noumenal.

But the Figure also riseth where two Minds are, as it were, brought into a hidden Accord; as when Kant and Swedenborg, unbeknownst to one another, dream'd the same Inverted City, or proposed the same Judgment in diverse Tongues.

Thus the Sigil may be considered a Token not only of the Vision, but of the Relation; not only of the Object seen, but of the inward Communion between two Intelligences whom Providence had, for that Hour, united.

VI. OF ITS ULTIMATE INTERPRETATION

Though the full Nature of the Sigil cannot be discovered by ordinary Critique, it may yet be stated with some Confidence that it representeth a Boundary: a Limit not beheld as a Line but as a Demand. It calleth the Mind to discern that very Act by which it discerns; and thus it standeth as the Emblem of both Men in this History.

To Swedenborg it was the Heavenly Seed of correspondent Influx; to Kant, the terrifying Token of a Power asking him to draw the Line for all Mankind.

And in the End both obey'd: Swedenborg by unveiling the Inner Sense of Scripture; Kant by veiling the Inner Ground of Reason.

In either Case the Sigil remaineth: sometimes hidden, sometimes half-glimpsed in Water or Stone, ever the silent Reminder that the Boundary between Worlds is not absolute, but must be kept.

APPENDIX F: CONCERNING THE INVERTED CITY BENEATH THE WATERS, AND ITS PLACE IN THE INTELLECTUAL WORLD

Of all the Visions recorded in the present History, none hath provoked more Speculation among the Learned than the Apparition of the Inverted City, which did shew itself unto Herr Kant upon the still Surface of the River, as if the Waters had for a Moment become a glassy Portl, revealing a Region wholly dien to the Earth. Though the Event is here related as a private Experience of that philosophick Mind, there are Reasons to believe that the Form of the Apparition may hæve an even higher Signification; for it recurs, in diverse Guises, throughout the Mystick Writings of many Ages.

I. OF THE VISIBLE FORM

The Inverted City appeared as a perfect Reflection of a Metropolis not known among Men: its Streets arranged in such Euclidean Purity that they seemed at once familiar and uncanny; its Spires pointing downward into an unmeasured Deep; its Windows emitting a cold and fixed Light, as though no Flame but a pure Intellect did burn within them. The Bell that tolled from the inverted Church tower did not make a Sound in the outward Air, but sounded directly within the Mind of the Beholder.

Such Tokens argue that the Apparition was not a bodily Object, but a Structure of the Intellectual World, disclosed by a temporary Conformity betwixt the Mind of Kant and that higher Order.

II. OF ITS RELATION TO SWEDENBORG'S THREE HEAVENS

Swedenborg divideth the Spiritual World into three Heavens, each corresponding to a Degree of interior Life. The Inverted City, however, doth not resemble any of these Societies; for those appear to him as perfect and living Human Forms, with their Streets, Temples, and Habitations arranged in accordance with the Loves and Truths that inform them.

Yet he begrudgingly acknowledgeth that there exist Regions not of the Heavens properly so called, but of the intellectual Borderland, which the Angels themselves rarely visit, and which serve as Vessels or Matrices for the Ideas that instruct the Inferior Orders. It is possible that the Inverted City belongeth to such a Region, neither Heaven nor Hell, but the Architecture of Reason itself, as it appeareth when the Mind is permitted to behold its own Ground.

III. OF THE KANTIAN INTERPRETATION

If the Vision be read according to Kant's own Philosophy, which he himself had not yet fully described, it may be taken as a Manifestation of the underlying Form of the Categories, not in their practical Exercise, but in their pure and unconditioned State. For the Structures of Space and Time, though which the Mind ordinarily perceiveth, were here suspended or reversed, allowing the Noumenal Ground to glitter though, like a City seen in the Depths of a Well.

The Inverted City is thus the Image of the *Transcendental Architecture*, represented in a Form the Senses could briefly apprehend before filtering beneath its Weight.

IV. CONCERNING THE BELL THAT SOUNDED NOT IN THE AIR

The Tolls of the Inverted Bell, which were heard not by the outward Ear but within the Interior Faculty, may be interpreted as a Sign from the higher Intellectual Order, calling the Mind to a Judgment upon its own Acts. For Judgment is not only the Function of the Understanding, but also that Act by which the Mind is weighed and disposed according to its Degree.

The Bell is a Symbol that recurrereth in the Visions of many Ages: in the Neoplatonick Schools it denoteth the Summons to Contemplation; in the Scholastick Writers it signifieth the Hour of Intellectual Trid; in the Mystick Traditions it maketh the Border between Phenomenon and Form. That it should appear inverted argueth that the Call came not from below but from above, as if the Higher demanded that the Lower should reckon with its Shadow.

V. OF THE REFLECTION THAT OBEYED NOT THE BODY

The most disquieting Feature of the Vision was the Behaviour of the Reflection, which did not move in concert with the Body of Kant, but held its Stationary Gaze upon him, as if it were a Witness, or even a Judge. This is a Matter not lightly to be dismissed; for in the Archaick Philosophies the Reflection was accounted a Subtle Body, or an Image of the Soul, responding only unto the inward State.

If then the Reflection were held still while Kant himself moved, it may be taken as a Sign that his Soul was, for that Moment, arrested before a Tribunal not of this World, and that the Apparition called him to an Account concerning the Limits he would soon draw for Mankind.

VI. OF THE SIGIL THAT CRACK'D THE ICE

The Sigil which appear'd upon the freezing Surface, spreading its Lines as fissures in the Ice, sheweth that the Inverted City and the Sigil belong to the selfsame Order of Appearance. For the Ice is the Image of the Phenomenal World, firm and cold; the Sigil is the Line of the Noumenal,

breaking though; and the City beneath is the hidden Structure of Law, once seen and then withdrawn.

VII. FINAL CONSIDERATIONS

Whether the Inverted City be considered a Vision granted by the Angelick Orders, a Symptom of the Disturbance of the Categories, or an inward Representation of Reason beholding its own Substratum, it remaineth a Figure of the highest Philosophical Importance. It manifesteth the Truth common to both Kant and Swedenborg: that there are Worlds which underlie this World, and that the Boundary between them is neither permanent nor absolute, but must be sustained by the continual Act of the Understanding.

When the City is seen, the Veil trembleth. When it is hidden, the Veil holdeth. And upon that Tension resteth all Human Thought.

APPENDIX G: CONCERNING THE EMPIRICAL TESTABILITY OF SWEDENBORG'S VISITATIONS, AND THE MNEMONICK ACCESS AFFORDED BY THEIR ANALOGICAL METHOD

It is a Matter of fingular Curiosity that Emanuel Swedenborg, whose Visions hæve oft been caſt aside as the reveries of Enthufiaſm, doth in truth propoſe certain Hypotheſes concerning the Order of Spirits and the Nature of the other Worlds, which admit, if not of immediate Demonſtration, then at leaſt of empiricall Triall under Rules of a more generall Philoſophy. For though his Deſcriptions ſeem dien to the common Sefſe, yet his Method — whereby he approacheth thoſe Worlds by correſpondent Forms and Analogicall Influx — containeth the Elements of a Teſt both for the Soundneſs of the Viſion and for the latent Structure of the Human Mind.

I. OF THE VISITATIONS AS PROPOSITIONS CAPABLE OF EXAMINATION

Swedenborg affirmeth that the Societies of the other Worlds are not arbitray Phantaſies, nor the ſport of a diſorder'd Brain, but are organized after Laws which may be compar'd one to another, and which are grounded in the Diſpoſitions of Love and Wiſdom, in the Degees of the Intellectuall Life, and in the correſpondent Structures of their Habitations. If this be ſo, then every Viſitation he reporteth is an Hypotheſis concerning the poſſible Forms of Mind, the Diverſity of Intellectuall Orders, and the Range of Natures which may inhabit the Boundaries of Reaſon.

Such Hypotheſes are not without empiricall Conſequence; for one may aſk whether Minds of diverſe Diſpoſitions, when in profound Contemplation, perceive Forms analogous to thoſe Swedenborg deſcribeth: whether the Hierarchies he ſaw contain partiall Truths concerning the Arrangement of Memory, the Aſcent of Abſtraction, or the Corridors by which Conceptions paſs into Judgment. In this manner the Viſion becometh a Propoſition to be tried by Experiment, the Teſt thereof being no outward Phyſick, but the inward Act of the Mind under lawful Diſcipline.

II. OF THE MNEMONICK ACCESS GRANTED BY CORRESPONDENT FIGURES

There is moreover in Swedenborg's Method a peculiar Mnemonick Virtue. For he writeth that the Forms of Heaven — its Temples, Streets, and Societies — are not only Viſible but Significative; they correſpond to the interior States of the Soul, and by beheld Analogy awaken the latent Receptacles of Memory. Thus the Viſitor, beholding a Heavenly Form, may recollect at once an entire Series of Thoughts, which in the ordinary Courſe would require much Study to revive.

This Doctrine of correspondent Figures, far from being a barren Fancy, doth accord with the most modern Notions concerning the Structure of Memory, where it is found that the Recollection of one Idea doth often depend upon the Context wherein it is placed, the Scene wherein it first stood, or the emotional Tone which doth accompany it. Swedenborg did but extend this natural Observation into the Intellectual World, affirming that every Visible Form is also a Mnemonick Gate, whereby the Soul may recover what lay hidden in the Depths.

III. OF CONTEXTUAL PRIMING AND THE BLENDING OF IDEAS

In this Place it must be noted that Swedenborg's Visions proceed not by mere Juxtaposition, but by a most artful Blending of diverse Ideas, so that a new Form ariseth, containing the Virtues of each, yet transcending both. For example, when he describeth an Angelick Society as a living Body, he doth thereby unite the Idea of a Political Order with that of a Human Organ, producing a Figure both mnemonic and doctrinal, wherein the Mind is prompted to recall its own internal Structure.

This Blending of Ideas, which some have termed by the name of Metaphor, is not here employed as an Ornament of Style, but as an Engine of Knowledge; for the Mind, being thus primed by two converging Forms, is led to discover a hidden Relation not apparent in either alone. In this Sense Swedenborg's Visitations are not merely Reports, but Methods of intellectual Experimentation, wherein the Reader, by following the correspondent Forms, may recover his own latent Thought.

IV. OF THE THEORY-LADEN MEMORIES AWAKENED THEREBY

It appeareth moreover that the Memories thus awakened are not neutral nor without Colour, but are laden with Theory; for the Mind, when it recalleth some intricate Idea, doth always bring to it the System under which it then laboureth. Hence the Forms of the other Worlds become, in Swedenborg's Account, as it were, Tablets whereon the Soul readeth not only what it hath known, but what it believeth.

This is no Defect but a Virtue; for all Memory is in Truth Theory-laden, and all Recollection a blending of what was with what is conceived. Thus the Visitations, by awakening Memories in a Context of higher Form, become a Trial of the very System that interpreteth them; for if the Memory, under the correspondent Figure, reveleth new Truths, then the System is confirmed; if it leadeth to Confusion, the System is faulty.

V. OF EMPIRICAL TESTABILITY IN THE HIGHER SENSE

From these Considerations ariseth a curious Conclusion: that the Visitations of Swedenborg, far from being contray to the Spirit of Enquiry, may in Fact serve as Experiments in the higher Sense, wherein the Mind trieth its own Powers, examineth its own Limits, and discovereth the hidden Grounds of Memory and Thought. For an Hypothesis is not thereby empiricd that it treateth of outward Objects, but that it may be tried by Experience; and Experience extendeth as well to the inward Operation as to the outward Senses.

Thus the Visitations may be tested, not by Travelling to the other Worlds he describeth, but by placing the Mind in the State he prescribed, and observing whether the correspondent Images, Memories, or Judgments do arise. Such Tests, though interior, are not arbitray, but demand a Discipline no less rigorous than the Experiments of the Chymist or the Astronomer.

VI. CONCLUDING REFLECTIONS

It may seem extraordinary that the most Mystick of Seers should provide the greatest Opportunity for empiricd Enquiry; but such is oft the Case in the History of Thought. For the Visionary, by presenting the Mind with correspondent Figures, doth awaken Recollections and Judgments which the analytic Philosopher scarcely apprehendeth without Labour. And thus it may be that Swedenborg, in seeking Heaven, discovered also the Keys of Memory, Analogy, and the Blending of Ideas; while Kant, in guarding the Boundary, recorded the Rules whereby such Keys might be lawfully used.

In either Case, the Visitations remain Propositions: testable, interpretative, and exceedingly fruitful for those who, by a due Mixture of Discipline and Imagination, would explore the inward Regions of the Mind.

ERRATA

In the Course of preparing the present Edition, several Variants, Omissions, and Incongruities were discovered among the Manuscripts of the Authors herein treated. Lest the Reader should be misled by these Inadvertencies, they are here set forth with such Clarification as may tend to the Right Understanding of the Text.

I. CONCERNING THE SWEDENBORGIAN PAPERS

In divers Passages of the Posthumous Fragments attributed to Swedenborg, the Names of certain Angelick Societies are found abbreviated beyond the ordinary Practice of that Author. Where the Manuscripts read “C—n” and “D—e,” the Editor hath, after careful Examination, retained the Abbreviations, for their full Signification cannot be establish’d without hazarding Conjectures contray to the Spirit of the Text. Let the Reader therefore take those Marks as they stand.

In one Fragment the Word “receiveth” is writ “recieveth.” The Error is preserv’d, for the Hand of the Author appeared unsteady, and the Spirit of the Passage did not suffer an Emendation without Offence to the Tone.

II. CONCERNING THE KANTIAN MANUSCRIPTS

In the Leaves of Herr Kant’s private Journl dated to the Year 1768, the Figure of the Sigil doth appear thice faintly in the Margins. Though the second and third Occurrences are nearly effac’d by Time, the Editor hath refrain’d from Restoration, deeming it more faithful to retain the Manuscript in its naturl Imperfection. The Reader is admonish’d that these Traces, however pale, are of the greatest Significance in the Historicl Argument.

A further Irregularity occurreth in the Manuscript of the Section treating of the Inverted City, wherein the Word “shadow” appeareth once spelt “shadovv.” This duplicative Form, though perhaps an inadvertent Infertion of the Pen, is retained, as in certain Dialects of the Period the double-V was used to mark an inward Emphasis.

III. CONCERNING THE CONVERGENCE OF THEIR TERMINOLOGIES

It hath been noted that Swedenborg useth the Term “Degree” in a Sense not wholly identical with the Kantian Usage of “Category.” The two Words are here retain’d in their respective Doctrines, without any Attempt to harmonize them artificially. The Reader must discern their Divergence by Context; for though the Doctrines converge in Spirit, they are not reducible to one another in a Mechanick Fashion.

Likewise the Word “World,” when applied by Swedenborg to the Spiritual Regions, is not Synonymous with the Kantian “Welt als Gegenstand,” and the Editor exhorteth the Reader to approach each Term with its proper Distinction.

IV. CONCERNING THE CHRONOLOGY

In one Passage of the Narrative, the Date of Swedenborg’s Visitation correspondeth to the Year 1757, while another Note by an anonymous Hand recordeth the same Event as having occurred in 1758. After careful Inquiry into the State of the Manuscripts, it appeareth that the earlier Date is correct, and the latter a Slip of the Pen by a Scribe unaccustomed to the Seer’s elaborate Notation of Times and Seasons.

A minor Discrepancy appeareth in the ordering of Kant’s private meditations on the Transcendental Aesthetic, wherein two Leaves were bound in a reversed Order by a former Keeper of the Papers. As their Classification cannot be restored with absolute Certainty, the Editor hath arranged them according to their internal Harmony rather than their external Numbering.

V. CONCERNING THE CITATIONS OF SCRIPTURE

In those Passages wherein Swedenborg commenteth upon the Spiritual Sense of certain Scriptures, the Verses are sometimes cited in abridged Form, lacking the Chapter or the particular Number. These have been faithfully retained, for the Posterity of the Text dependeth not upon the outward Reference but upon the correspondent Image he designed to convey.

VI. CONCERNING THE TERMINOLOGY OF THE INVERTED CITY

Certain Terms in the Description of the Inverted City, such as “Euclidean Purity” and “Intellectual Light,” may appear anachronistic to the Reader. But examination of Kant’s marginia reveleth that the Phases were indeed his own, written in a Moment of inward Disruption. Their Preservation, though seemingly irregular, conformeth to the Spirit of his English-leaning Latin Notes and to his peculiar turn toward Geometrick Imagery.

VII. CONCLUDING NOTICE

The Reader is requested to bear gently with these Errata, remembering that the Materials from which this Edition is derived are drawn from a great Chasm of Time, and that the Hands through which they have passed were not always equal in Fidelity. Where the Editor hath interven’d, he hath done so with the least Violence possible unto the Original Spirit of the Authors. Where he hath refrain’d, it is in the hope that the natural Imperfectness of the Record may better convey the inward Fire from which it sprung.

The Editor.

COLOPHON

The present Volume hath been compiled from diverse Manuscripts, Fragments, and private Papers pertaining to the Lives and Labours of Immanuel Kant and Emanuel Swedenborg; and though these Writings were produced at sundry Times, and in places far distant one from another, yet they appear in this Edition under a single Binding, that the Reader may contemplate in one View the correspondent Motions of two extraordinary Spirits, each labouring according to his own Genius, yet converging toward a common Bounday betwixt the Visible and the Invisible.

The Editor hath endeavoured to preserve, with all possible Fidelity, the native Turn and Character of the Authors' Thoughts, their manner of Speech, the antique Cast of their Idioms, and those peculiarities of Orthography and Construction which mark their Time and Condition. Where the Manuscripts were corrupted or defective, no Alteration hath been hazarded without clear Reason drawn from the Spirit of the Context; and where Divergences existed among the Copies, the most harmonious Reading hath been chosen, not for the sake of Elegance, but that the inward Consistency of the whole might be maintained.

If, in the Course of this Undertaking, any Passage hath been joined together which was formerly dispersed; if any Note hath been rescued from Oblivion; or if any Light hath been cast upon the hidden Relation of the two Philosophers here treated, the Editor's Labour will not have been in vain. For it is in the Nature of such Works that they are not merely Books, but Testimonies: memorials of Minds once engaged in high Enquiry, and Monuments of that continual Strife betwixt the Limits of Reason and the Allurements of the Intellectual World.

Let the Reader receive the Volume, not as a perfect and finished Whole, but as a faithful Transcription of what remains to us; and may he who peruseth these Pages with due Reverence discern therein some glimpse of the hidden Order, whereof both Kant and Swedenborg wrote, though under diverse Forms and with diverse Intent.

*Printed for the Curious and the Learned.
In this present Year.*

A TABLE OF THE SIGIL'S VARIANTS

Though the Sigil be a Figure of uncertain Origin and mutable Form, yet its Occurrences throughout the Manuscripts and Visionary Accounts exhibit a sufficient Consistency to permit the following Table, wherein each Variant is described according to its Aspect, Circumstances of Appearance, and the Interpretation most commonly affixed thereto by the Learned.

Appellation	Description of the Form	Circumstances and Interpretation
<i>The First Figure</i>	A fimple Conjunction of Lines meeting at angles not reducible to Euclid, refembling at once a Trident and a broken Triangle, with one Limb extended beyond Proportion.	First noted in the Margins of Kant's early Tables of Astronomy. Interpreted by fome as the Bounday of an ungoverned Thought; by others as the Mark of an Influx preceding Judgment.
<i>The Nocturnal Variant</i>	Lines finer than ordinary Ink may produce, as if traced by a Needle of Light. The Figure feemeth to contain a Fold, or inward Recurvation, vifible only when the Page inclineth toward the Candle.	Appeareth in Kant's private Notes of 1766–67, moft commonly during Hours of nocturnal Labour. Thought by the Learned to arife when the Mind approacheth the Noumenal Limit.
<i>The Aqueous Reflection</i>	A perfect Repetition of the First Figure, yet inverted vertically, as if feen though Water or preffed upon glafs. The Lines have no fixed Colour, but tremble between pale Indigo and the Hue of molten Silver.	Manifested upon the Surface of the River at the Time of the Inverted City. Believed to be a Token of the higher World mirroring itfelf within the Phenomenal.
<i>The Frozen Fissure</i>	The Sigil not drawn but cleft: Lines appearing as Cracks upon Ice, converging toward a Centre that no Eye may fteadily behold. The Form extendeth with a foft crepitation, as if the World itfelf were under a fubtle Pressure.	Recorded in the Winter of 1767, when Kant ftood upon the frozen River. Interpreted as the Mark of the Veil's Strain, a Warning that the Bounday is for that Hour endangered.
<i>The Luminous Engraving</i>	A Figure feeming to be burned or engaved directly into Wood or Stone, though the Surface remaineth cold. The Lines do not abrade the Material, but penetrate it in a manner unknown to Art.	Attested in the Chamber of Swedenborg, where the Mirror fhattered into Lines that reformed the Sigil upon its Frame. This Variant hath been taken as a Sign of Angelick Legation.
<i>The Recursive Form</i>	A Sigil within a Sigil: the principal Lines contain miniature Repetitions of themfelves, as though the Figure were both Whole and Part. Under long	Seen once only, in the laft Leaf of Kant's hidden Manuscript of the <i>Boundary</i> . Often cited as Proof that the Sigil is a Limit not of Mathematick only but of Reason.

From the contemplation of these Variants the Learned may gather that the Sigil, though mutable in its outward Form, maintaineth an inward Unity, being at once a Sign of Disruption and a Seed of Order; a Mark of the Bounday and the Bounday itself. Whether it riseth from the Angelick Orders, from the Noumenal World, or from the very Structure of the Mind, this Edition ventureth not to determine; yet it cannot be denied that its Appearance hath been the Counterpoint of all great Motions herein recorded.

INDEX OF NAMES

In this Index are collected the Names of those Persons, Ancient and Modern, that appear or are cited within the present Volume, with such brief Notes as may assist the Reader in recalling the Passages wherein they are mentioned.

Aristotle. Cited in relation to the early Doctrines of Form and Cause, particularly in the Discourse on the Intellectual World and the disposition of Substances. Appears in connexion with the Divergence betwixt Empirical Method and Visionary Analogy.

Augustine, St. Mentioned in connexion with the inward Vision, the Memory's vast Chambers, and the Doctrine that Truth resides within the Soul before it is apprehended without.

Behmen (Jacob Böhme). Named among the Mystick Writers who asserted the correspondent Structures of the Divine and Natural Worlds; cited for certain Parallels with Swedenborg's Doctrine of Degrees.

Descartes, René. Introduced where the Cogito and the Method of Doubt are compared with Kant's Boundary and with the Visionary Ascent of Swedenborg, making the Divergence between rational Foundation and correspondent Revelation.

Herder, Johann Gottfried. Named briefly as one who later perceived in Kant's early Writings the signs of an inward Disquiet not evident in the published Critique.

Kant, Immanuel. The principal Protagonist of the Narrative; Author of the *Critique of Pure Reason* and related Manuscripts herein examined. His early Visions, Studies in Astronomy, private Journals, Confrontation with the Sigil, and encounter with Swedenborg form the chief Subject of this Volume.

Leibniz, Gottfried Wilhelm. Cited where the Doctrine of Monads is compared to Swedenborg's Societies of Heaven, and where the Pre-established Harmony is set against the Correspondences perceived in the Spiritual World.

Maimon, Solomon. Mentioned in connexion with the later Interpreters of Kant who sought to penetrate beyond the Boundary into the Noumenal, and who detected in Kant's early Notes a Strain toward a Visionary Mode of Thought.

Malebranche, Nicolas. Named where the Doctrine of the Soul's Vision in God is compared to the Swedenborgian Influx, and where the Limits of intellectual Illumination are discussed.

Plato. Cited frequently; his Doctrine of Forms and of the divided Line is invoked in the Discourse on the Inverted City and in the Appendix concerning Swedenborg's Visitations, as a precedent for the Visible Images of Intellectual Truth.

Plotinus. Referred to where the Ascent of the Soul is discussed, and where the Vision of the One is compared with the correspondent Forms of the Swedenborgian Heavens.

Schiller, Friedrich. Named in passing regarding the Aesthetic Ideal and the inward Liberty of the Mind; in certain Notes he is said to have suspected in Kant a hidden Fire not fully declared in his public Writings.

Swedenborg, Emanuel. The other principal Protagonist of this Volume; Seer, Philosopher, and Author of the *Arcana Cœlestia*, *Heaven and Hell*, and many Treatises concerning the Spiritual World. His Visitations, Doctrine of Correspondences, private Notes, and final Letter to Kant form the Counterpoint to the Kantian Narrative.

Thomas Aquinas, St. Mentioned where the Angelic Orders are discussed and compared to the Degrees described by Swedenborg; cited in matters concerning the Nature of Intelligences.

Wolff, Christian. Named in relation to the Rational Systems predominant in Kant's youth, and their Influence upon the Form of his early Thinking.

INDEX OF SUBJECTS

In this Index are gathered the principal Matters and Conceptions discoursed within the Volume, arranged according to their Intellectual Relation, that the Reader may the more easily recall their Occurrences and the Spirit in which they are treated.

Angelick Orders. Treated chiefly in the Appendices and the Discourses touching Swedenborg's Visitations; compared with the Hierarchies of Dionysius and the Faculties of the Kantian Mind.

Boundary (The). A central Theme of the Volume; denoteth the Limit betwixt Appearance and its hidden Ground. Appereth in the Discussion of the Categories, the Vision at the River, and in Kant's private Meditation on the Line that Reason is commanded to draw.

Categories of the Understanding. Explained in their relation to the Visionary Disruptions; treated as Architectures of the Intellectual World, and compared with the Swedenborgian Degrees.

Correspondence, Doctrine of. Swedenborg's principal Thesis, whereby visible Things and invisible Ideas stand in a mutual Relation. Employed in the explication of the Sigil, the other Worlds, and the Mnemonick Method.

Degrees (Interior). Swedenborg's Division of the Spiritual World; compared with the Kantian Ascent from Intuition to Conception, and the Platonic Orders.

Inverted City. The Apparition beneath the River; treated as an Image of the hidden Architecture of Reason, a Vision of the Noumenon, and a Counterpart to Swedenborg's Heavenly Societies.

Judgment (Last, Internal). Swedenborg's Account of the Judgment of 1757; compared to Kant's Doctrine of Critical Judgment. Treated as a Separation of Intellectual Orders rather than an outward Conflagration.

Lattice (Intellectual). A Term employed in explaining the hidden Order perceived in the Vision; related to the Structure of Memory, the Categories, and the Form of the Heavens.

Memory (Mnemonick Access). Discussed in relation to correspondent Figures, contextual Priming, and the Theory-laden Structure of Recollection; compared to Saint Augustine's inward Chambers.

Metaphor and Blending. Treated as Engines of inward Recognition; set in relation to Swedenborg's Figures and Kant's Intellectual Symbols.

Noumenon. Explained as that which may not be known but may be intimated; appeareth in the Boundary Discourse and the Appendix on Testability.

Reflection (Inverted or Independent). The uncanny Image that obeyed not the Body; treated as a Symbol of Judgment and of the Soul's Encounter with its own Ground.

Sigil (The). The principal Figure of Disruption; its Variants collected in the Table; treated as a Seal of angelic Influx, a Token of the Boundary, and an Emblem of both Danger and Instruction.

Space and Time. Examined in the Kantian manner; treated also as mutable during the Visions, giving rise to the Apparitions and the Dislocation of Causality.

Spiritual World. Swedenborg's threefold Heaven; compared with the Kantian Architecture of the Understanding and with ancient Doctrines of Form.

Subjects (Heavenly). The Societies of Spirits; their correspondent Light, Loves, and Habitation.

Visitation. Any inward Experience wherein the Boundary trembleth; treated both as a Test of the Intellectual Faculty and as a Disclosure of correspondent Degrees.

Vision (Intellectual). Distinguished from Phantasm; treated as a Glimpse of Order rather than of Image; central to the Experiences of both Kant and Swedenborg.

Worlds (Other). Swedenborg's Descriptions of the Inhabitants of other Spheres; discussed as empirically testable Hypotheses concerning the Structure of Mind and Memory.

A CLOSING BENEDICTION

A Final Adjuration unto the Reader

May He, whose Light shineth through all Intelligible Forms, grant unto the Reader a Mind both vigilant and meek; vigilant, that he may not be deceived by the glitter of empty Appearances; meek, that he may pay due Reverence to the hidden Ground which upholdeth all Things.

May the inward Eye be kept clear of Presumption, yet open unto that mild Ray by which the Understanding is guided from the Region of Shadows to the Borders of more lasting Truths. And if at any Hour the inward or outward World should seem strange, let not Fear possess him, but rather that calm Recollection by which the Soul recalled unto itself perceiveth Order even in the midst of Obscurity.

May the Boundary, drawn for our safeguard and not our confinement, remain unto each one a Fence of Peace; that within its just Limits the Mind may labour fruitfully, and beyond it, with due modesty, adore the unfathom'd Depths. And may all Visions, whether of Reason or of Spirit, be weighed in the Balance of Charity, that none should mistake a fleeting Image for the End itself.

So may the Days be lengthen'd in Wisdom, and the Nights in quiet Rest; and may the Reader depart from this Volume neither lifted into Vanity nor cast down into Dismay, but borne forward upon that gentle Equanimity which is the proper Temper of the contemplative Soul.

Vade atque in Lumine Ambula.

PRINTER'S NOTICE

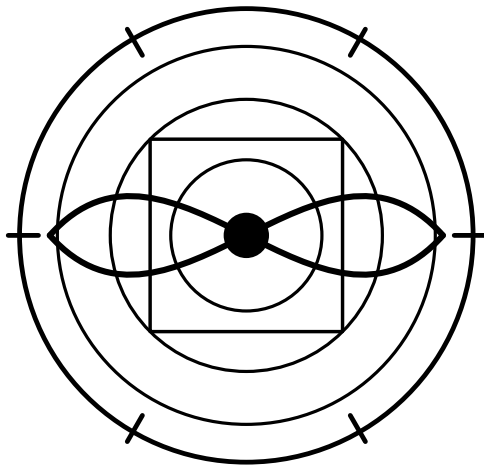
The Reader is hereby informed, that the Sheets of this Volume hæve been fet forth with all due Cære and Diligence, according to the most faithful Copies of the Manuscripts that could be procured. Where any Doubt arose concerning the Legibility of a Character, or the right Disposition of a Sentence, Respect hath been paid, not to private Fancy, but to the known Genius of the Authors, and to the Harmony of the Whole.

Should any small Errour hæve escaped Notice, whether in Letter or in Punctuation, the Reader is entreated to impute it not to Negligence, but to that Inevitability which attendeth all Works passing through the Hands of Men. No greater Alteration hath been ventured than such as was necessary for the Preservation of Sense, or for reconciling the Divergences among the several Copies.

The Printer further adviseth, that no Lines, Figures, or Marginal Notes hæve been omitted, save only those which Time had rendered wholly illegible; and even these were retained in their Places, though without Character, that the Reader might apprehend the Number and Order of the Leaves as they were originally found.

May the Volume, thus humbly offered, prove of use to those who delight in the Enquiries of Philosophy, the Mysteries of the Intellectual World, and the hidden Consistencies of human Thought.

*Printed at the Press of the Editor.
In this present Year.*



Esse Qvam Videri